

BENGUET STATE UNIVERSITY

DEBATE SOCIETY



RULES AND PROCEDURES

“The Blue Book”

OPERATIONAL GUIDELINES & GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK



Academic Year 2026 - 2027

First Edition

Ratified by Majority Vote of the Society Assembly
in accordance with Article 9, Section 2 of the Constitution

Date of Ratification: June 4, 2026

Constitutional Supremacy Note

In accordance with **Article IX, Section 7(3)** of these Rules and Procedures: *"In the event of any conflict between these Rules and Procedures and the Constitution of the BSU Debate Society, the Constitution shall prevail. Any provision of these Rules found to be inconsistent with the Constitution shall be deemed null and void to the extent of the inconsistency."*

Article I.

HOUSE POINT SYSTEM

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

The House Point System is established as an operational mechanism under these Rules and Procedures to promote and ensure constructive and healthy competition among Society Houses, recognize excellence in debate and organizational contribution, and strengthen House identity and camaraderie in accordance with Article 3, Section 7 of the Society Constitution. Amendments to this System shall follow the procedures in Article IX.

Section 2. Definitions.

For purposes of this System, the following terms shall be defined as follows:

- (1) *House-wide event* shall mean an activity organized by a House primarily for its members, though open to other Society members for observation or participation. For the purpose of point calculation, members from other Houses who attend shall be considered guests and shall not be included in the attendance percentage of the hosting House.
- (2) *Active member* shall mean a member who has attended at least seventy-five percent (75%) of House activities, has paid all required fees for the semester, and, if applicable, has completed the mandatory one (1) academic semester Executive Internship under Article 5, Section 2 of the Constitution.
- (3) *House Resources* shall mean funds, equipment, materials, or digital assets held in the name of or allocated to a specific House, as distinct from Society-wide resources managed by the High Council.
- (4) *Minor disciplinary sanction* shall mean a first-time violation of the House Code of Conduct involving failure to complete assigned House tasks, or minor disrespect during House proceedings that does not disrupt the activity.
- (5) *Major disciplinary sanction* shall mean any violation involving dishonesty in House matters, harassment or intimidation of fellow members, intentional disruption of House or Society activities, repeated minor violations after receiving a formal written warning, or any act that brings disrepute to the House or Society.
- (6) *Accomplishment Report* shall mean a formal submission by a House documenting an activity eligible for points under this System, containing the elements specified in Section 5(1), and certified by the House Chancellor or designated officer.
- (7) *The High Tribunal (Point Dispute Session)* shall be the adjudicatory body convened solely for the purpose of resolving petitions and disputes regarding the House Point

System. It shall be composed of the Society President as Presiding Judge and all four House Chancellors as the Jury of the Pillars per Constitution Art. 10. In Point Disputes, the Chancellor of the House directly involved shall serve as Defense Chancellor per the adversarial mandate of Constitution Art. 10, Sec. 3. Voting on the point transaction shall be conducted by the three uninvolved Chancellors, unless the Constitution expressly requires the participation of all four. The High Tribunal shall convene only when a formal petition is filed regarding a point transaction.

Section 3. Point Categories and Values.

Points shall be awarded or deducted across four (4) primary categories.

- (1) The first category shall be known as Competitive Excellence. Houses shall earn one hundred (+100) points for first place in an inter-House debate tournament, seventy-five (+75) points for second place, and fifty (+50) points for third place. The member recognized as Best Speaker in any tournament shall earn twenty-five (+25) points for their House. For external competitions where members represent Benguet State University, winning an international, national, regional, or local championship shall earn fifty (+50) points, achieving semi-finalist or finalist status shall earn thirty (+30) points, and participation shall earn ten (+10) points. Placement points and participation points are mutually exclusive; a House that earns placement points in a competition shall not receive additional participation points for the same event.
- (2) The second category shall be known as Organizational Contribution. Points shall be awarded based on activities that demonstrate each House's core embodied value, as defined in the Society Constitution and House Charters.
 - (a) For House of Bathala (Leadership): A House-led initiative that develops leadership competencies among members, such as mentorship programs, leadership workshops, member-led projects that empower others, or activities that cultivate decision-making and team management skills, shall earn one hundred (+100) points. Documentation must include participant feedback, measurable outcomes, or evidence of skill development.
 - (b) For House of Kabunian (Journalism): A House-led initiative that advances communication, documentation, or media excellence, such as producing high-quality debate chronicles, creating informative content about Society activities, conducting interviews with notable speakers, or maintaining accurate and engaging public records, shall earn one hundred (+100) points. Documentation must include published materials, verifiable outputs, or audience engagement metrics.

- (c) For House of Laon (Academic): A House-led initiative that promotes intellectual growth, research, or scholarly inquiry, such as organizing research forums, producing case briefs on complex topics, hosting academic skill-building sessions, or facilitating critical analysis workshops, shall earn one hundred(+100) points. Documentation must include academic outputs, participant learning assessments, or evidence of intellectual rigor.
 - (d) For House of Manama (Arts): A House-led initiative that develops creativity, artistic expression, or cultural appreciation, such as producing creative debate formats, designing artistic materials for Society events, organizing cultural showcases, or integrating performance elements into discourse, shall earn one hundred (+100) points. Documentation must include creative outputs, event records, or evidence of artistic innovation.
 - (e) Houses that co-host an initiative together involving two Houses shall each earn twenty (+20) points, provided that the activity meaningfully integrates the embodied values of both participating Houses.
 - (f) Recruitment efforts shall be rewarded with five (+5) points for each new member who remains active for at least one(1) semester.
 - (g) No single activity shall be claimed for points under more than one category within this Section. Each activity must be classified based on its primary purpose and embodied value as determined by the High Council during the point transaction review process.
- (3) The third category shall be known as Governance and Compliance. Houses that submit required reports on time shall earn five (+5) points. House Council meetings with complete attendance of Council members shall earn three (+3) points. Conversely, late submission of requirements shall result in a deduction of three (-3) points per day, up to a maximum of fifteen points (-15). Failure to submit financial reports shall result in a twenty-point (-20) deduction. Unauthorized use of House Resources, defined as the use of House funds, equipment, or materials for personal gain or non-Society purposes without prior approval from the House Council, shall result in a deduction equal to seventy-five percent (-75%) of the House's current point total at the time of the violation.
- (4) The fourth category shall be known as Conduct and Ethics.
- (a) *Minor Violations.* A minor disciplinary sanction, as defined in Section 2(4), shall result in a five-point (-5) deduction to the member's House.
 - (b) *Major Violations.* A major disciplinary sanction, as defined in Section 2(5), shall result in a fifteen-point (-15) deduction to the member's House.

- (c) *Severe Violations.* Violations of the House Code of Conduct involving discrimination, exclusionary behavior based on protected characteristics, or intentional misrepresentation of facts in official House communications shall result in a thirty-point (-30) deduction.
- (d) *Procedural Implementation.* Point deductions for disciplinary sanctions shall not be self-reported by House Councils. Instead, the Society Office of Internal Affairs (OIA) shall instruct the Point Keeper to deduct points based on entries in the Society Disciplinary Ledger maintained under Article VI, Section 8.
- (e) *Concealment Penalty.* Failure by a House Council to submit a finalized Minor Violation sanction to the Society OIA within the prescribed period shall be classified as a Major Violation (Dishonesty/Concealment) under Article VI, Section 2(2)(b) or Article I, Section 2(5), resulting in a thirty-point (-30) deduction and potential disciplinary action against the House Council officers.

Section 4. Authority to Award Points.

The authority to award or deduct points under this System is divided between administrative posting and judicial adjudication. The Secretary of Internal Affairs shall have the authority to post points provisionally based on submitted Accomplishment Reports that are sufficient in form and substance. The High Tribunal shall have the sole authority to adjudicate disputed point transactions and render final decisions on petitions. The High Council President shall not possess the authority to propose point credits or debits. The President shall serve exclusively as the Presiding Judge of the High Tribunal during point dispute proceedings to ensure impartiality. No other officer, including House Chancellors, House Councils, or individual members, possesses independent authority to award or deduct points outside of this process. All point transactions must follow the process outlined in Section 5.

Section 5. Point Transaction Process.

- (1) Any House that conducts an activity eligible for points under Section 3 or Section 10 shall submit an Accomplishment Report to the Secretary of Internal Affairs within seven (7) calendar days of the activity's completion. The Accomplishment Report must include the name, date, and primary purpose of the activity, the category under which points are claimed, the specific point amount claimed with reference to the applicable subsection, supporting documentation such as attendance sheets or photos, and the signature of the House Chancellor certifying the report's accuracy.
- (2) Upon receipt of an Accomplishment Report that is sufficient in form and substance, the Secretary of Internal Affairs shall post the claimed points to the Master House Point Ledger within three business days. The posting shall be marked as Provisional Subject to

Petition for a period of seven (7) calendar days from the date of posting. During this period, the points shall be included in the published standings but may be reversed if a valid petition is filed.

- (3) Any of the three Houses not claiming the points may file a written petition to challenge a posted point transaction within seven calendar days of its posting to the Ledger. Grounds for petition include the activity not qualifying for the claimed category, insufficient or inaccurate documentation, materially misstated attendance or participation figures, or violation of Section 3(2) regarding multiple category claims. The petition must be submitted to the Secretary of Internal Affairs with specific grounds and supporting evidence. Upon the filing of a valid petition, the High Tribunal shall be convened. The House that submitted the Accomplishment Report shall be the Respondent, represented by its House Chancellor. The three other Houses shall collectively serve as the Petitioners, represented by their respective House Chancellors.
- (4) The High Tribunal shall be presided over by the Society President, who shall serve as the Judge. The President shall not vote on the decision but shall rule on procedural matters, ensure due process, and certify the final decision. The House Chancellors of the three Plaintiff Houses shall deliberate and vote by majority to uphold, modify, or reverse the point transaction. The Respondent House Chancellor shall have the right to present evidence and defend the claim. A decision shall be rendered within fourteen calendar days of the petition filing. The decision of the High Tribunal is final and executory regarding point transactions, with no further appeal permitted unless a constitutional violation is alleged.
- (5) If an Accomplishment Report is found by the High Tribunal to contain knowingly false or materially inaccurate information, the submitting House shall forfeit the claimed points, receive a deduction equal to the claimed point amount as a penalty, and be required to submit a corrective report within three days. Repeated violations may result in referral to the High Council for disciplinary action under Section 3(5).
- (6) If no petition is filed within the seven-day petition period, the provisional status shall be removed, and the points shall become final and executory. The Secretary of Internal Affairs shall update the Ledger accordingly and notify the submitting House of finalization.

Section 6. Provisional Sanctions for Major Violations.

In cases where a House Council independently initiates disciplinary action against one of its own members for a major violation as defined in Section 2(5), the House Council may recommend a provisional point deduction pending full review by the High Council. Such provisional deduction shall not exceed fifteen (-15) points and shall be subject to restoration if the High Council

overturns the sanction. The Secretary of Internal Affairs shall note the provisional status in the Master House Point Ledger until final disposition. This provision shall not apply to complaints initiated by external parties, which shall follow the standard process in Section 5 without provisional deduction.

Section 7. Tracking and Transparency.

- (1) The Master House Point Ledger shall be maintained in digital format by the Secretary of Internal Affairs, with the Executive Secretary serving as the formal custodian of all records in accordance with Article 8, Section 6 of the Constitution and Article VIII of these Rules. The Ledger shall record the date, House, points added or deducted, running total, category, specific activity or reason, proposing House, and final disposition by the High Council.
- (2) All Society members shall have view access to the Ledger through the Society's official online platform. Edit access shall be restricted to the Secretary of Internal Affairs only. Standings shall be posted online on the Society's official digital platforms following each processed point transaction and shall be updated in real time. A summary report with category breakdowns shall be presented monthly at the Society Assembly Meeting. The published standings shall display each House's total points along with a breakdown by category to ensure transparency and allow Houses to track their progress across different areas of contribution.

Section 8. Appeals and Dispute Resolution.

- (1) This Section shall govern appeals of final point transactions only. A House may appeal a final point transaction only on the grounds of alleged violation of constitutional rights under Article 4 (Rights of Members) of the Constitution. The appeal must be submitted via written Appeal Form to the Council of House Chancellors.
- (2) If the appeal is approved for hearing, the Society Adviser shall serve as the Presiding Judge. The Society Chief Adviser shall review the constitutional appeal within five(5) business days. A decision shall be rendered within fourteen(14) calendar days of the appeal filing. The Council of House Chancellors may provide advisory input, but the Adviser's decision shall be final per Constitution Art. 10, Sec. 5.

Section 9. The House Cup.

- (1) The House Cup shall be awarded at the end of each academic year to the House with the highest cumulative point total. The competition period shall begin on the first day of the First Semester and end on the last day of the Second Semester. Points shall reset to zero (0) at the start of each new academic year.

- (2) In the event of a tie, the following tiebreaker sequence shall apply. First, the House with the highest points in debate competitions, including both inter-House tournaments and external events, shall be declared the winner. If still tied, the House with the highest member participation rate, measured as the percentage of House members active in Society activities, shall win. If still tied, the House with the lowest point deductions, meaning the fewest conduct or compliance violations, shall win. If still tied, the head-to-head record between the tied Houses shall be considered. If a tie persists after all preceding criteria, the winner shall be determined by drawing of lots.
- (3) The winning House shall receive a physical House Cup trophy bearing a removable plaque with the academic year and House name affixed for that year only, and a certificate of recognition. Material benefits include an additional two hundred Philippine pesos (₱200) budget allocation from the Society treasury, subject to the availability of funds. Competitive advantages include automatic qualification to the finals of the next year's premier inter-House tournament and the right to propose one debate topic for the opening tournament.
- (4) In addition to the annual House Cup, a House of the Semester recognition shall be awarded to the top House at the end of each semester. This House shall receive a certificate and public recognition, and shall carry over ten (+10) bonus points to the next semester. This semester recognition is separate from and does not affect the House Cup competition.

Section 10. Special Competitions and Bonuses.

- (1) An Inter-House Debate Cup shall be held each semester as a distinct competition series with mandatory participation from all Houses in a round-robin format where each House debates every other House once. Points awarded under this subsection are separate from and cumulative with points awarded under Section 3(1) for standalone inter-House debate tournaments. No single debate match shall be counted for points under both subsections; each match shall be classified as either part of the League or a standalone tournament by the High Council prior to the event. Points for the League shall be awarded as follows: fifteen (+15) points for a win, seven (+7) points for a draw, and three (+3) points for participation. Placement points and participation points are mutually exclusive; a House that earns placement points shall not receive additional participation points for the same match. An additional five (+5) bonus points shall be awarded for the best team performance as determined by tournament judges.
- (2) Annual Excellence Awards shall be presented at the end of each academic year. The Award for Historical Integrity, worth twenty-five (+25) points, recognizes the House that best embodies the value of transparency and accountability through comprehensive and accurate documentation of its activities. The Award for Commitment to Inclusive

Dialogue, worth twenty-five (+25) points, recognizes the House that best embodies the Society's principle of diversity and inclusion through its activities and member engagement. The Award for Innovation in Debate, worth twenty-five (+25) points, recognizes the House that demonstrates creativity and adaptability in argumentation and event design. The Award for Community Impact, worth twenty-five (+25) points, recognizes the House whose outreach efforts most effectively serve the broader community. The Award for Member Development, worth twenty-five (+25) points, recognizes the House with the highest rate of member retention and growth from the start to the end of the academic year. The Rising House Award, worth twenty-five (+25) points, recognizes the most improved House based on semester-to-semester point increase.

- (3) Bonus point opportunities shall be available throughout the year. For purposes of attendance-based bonuses, only bona fide members of the House as recorded in the official House Membership Database maintained by the Secretary of Internal Affairs shall be counted. A House with perfect attendance (one hundred percent / 100%) from all its bona fide members at all Society Assembly Meetings for an entire semester shall earn fifteen (+15) bonus points. A House with ninety percent (90%) or higher attendance from all its bona fide members at all Society Assembly Meetings for an entire semester shall earn ten (+10) bonus points. These attendance bonus points shall be awarded to the House as a collective entity and shall not be allocated to individual members. A House with zero (0) conduct violations for an entire semester shall earn ten (+10) bonus points. Cross-House collaboration involving three or more Houses shall earn thirty (+30) bonus points. This bonus is cumulative with points earned under Section 3(2) for event co-hosting. A member who wins an external individual award in a debate, public speaking, or academically recognized competition shall earn fifteen (+15) bonus points for their House, provided that:

- (a) the awarding organization is a recognized academic, student, or professional body;
- (b) the award is documented by an official certificate, letter, or published result; and
- (c) the award is submitted to the Secretary of Internal Affairs within fourteen days (14) of receipt.

A House that hosts a visit from an external organization shall earn ten (+10) bonus points.

Section 11. Administration and the Point Keeper.

- (1) The Point Keeper shall be the Secretary of Internal Affairs of the High Council. The Point Keeper shall serve for one academic year and may be renewed at the discretion of the High Council President. Qualifications for the role include being a member in good

standing, having no active disciplinary sanctions, demonstrating organizational skills and attention to detail, and maintaining impartiality and confidentiality.

- (2) The responsibilities of the Point Keeper include maintaining the Master House Point Ledger, reviewing Point Transaction Forms for sufficiency in form and substance, publishing standings online according to the schedule in Section 7, responding to House inquiries within forty-eight hours, preparing semester point reports for the Council of House Chancellors, archiving all Point Transaction Forms and supporting documents in coordination with the Executive Secretary, and coordinating with House Chancellors on point-related matters. The Point Keeper may designate an Assistant Point Keeper to assist with data entry and verification, serve as backup during absence, and help with publication and communication.

Section 12. Transitory Provisions.

Upon adoption of this House Point System, points shall commence from the date of ratification by members in a general meeting in accordance with Article 11, Section 1 of the Constitution. All Houses shall start with a baseline of zero (0) points. The first House Cup competition period shall begin immediately upon adoption. For the first academic year, the High Council President shall designate the initial Point Keeper within two weeks of this System's adoption. A one-month transition period shall be observed from the adoption date to allow for orientation of House Chancellors on procedures, setup of the Master House Point Ledger, distribution of Point Transaction Forms, and training of the Point Keeper. During this transition period, point awards may be processed with a relaxed five-day submission deadline instead of the standard three days.

Section 13. Effectivity.

This House Point System, as part of the Rules and Procedures of the BSU Debate Society, shall take effect upon ratification by majority vote of members in a general meeting in accordance with Article 11, Section 1 of the Constitution. It shall remain in effect until amended or repealed according to the procedures outlined in Section 12.

Article II.

INDIVIDUAL RECOGNITION FRAMEWORK

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

The Individual Recognition Framework is established to acknowledge and celebrate the contributions, growth, and excellence of individual members of the Society. This Framework operates alongside the House Point System and is designed to complement, not replace, the House-focused competition structure. Recognition under this Framework shall be ceremonial and honorary; it shall not confer voting rights, office eligibility, or material benefits beyond those explicitly stated herein. All individual recognition shall align with the Society's principles under Article 3 of the Constitution, particularly Sections 7 (constructive competition), 9 (continuous growth), and 10 (education as empowerment).

Section 2. Categories of Individual Recognition.

Individual members may be recognized for excellence in four categories, each aligned with the embodied value of a Society House.

- (1) *Leadership Excellence.* This category recognizes members who demonstrate exceptional leadership competencies, including but not limited to: initiating and leading successful House or Society projects; mentoring newer members with measurable impact; facilitating constructive dialogue during debates or meetings; or representing the Society with distinction in external leadership forums. Nominees must have completed at least one semester as an active member.
- (2) *Communication and Documentation Excellence.* This category recognizes members who advance the Society's communication, documentation, or media excellence, including but not limited to: producing high-quality debate chronicles, articles, or reports; creating informative or engaging content about Society activities; conducting insightful interviews or research; or maintaining accurate and accessible public records. Nominees must have contributed at least three documented outputs during the recognition period.
- (3) *Academic and Intellectual Excellence.* This category recognizes members who promote intellectual growth, research, or scholarly inquiry, including but not limited to: producing well-researched case briefs or position papers; organizing or leading academic skill-building sessions; demonstrating exceptional critical analysis in debates or forums; or contributing original research or literature reviews to the Society's knowledge base. Nominees must have completed at least one semester as an active member.
- (4) *Creative and Artistic Excellence.* This category recognizes members who develop creativity, artistic expression, or cultural appreciation, including but not limited to: designing artistic materials for Society events; integrating performance or creative

elements into debate formats; organizing cultural showcases or artistic workshops; or producing original creative works that reflect the Society's values. Nominees must have contributed at least two documented creative outputs during the recognition period.

- (5) Individual recognition categories are aligned with the embodied values of Society Houses for symbolic and aspirational purposes only. Eligibility for nomination and selection in any category shall be open to all active members of the Society, irrespective of their House affiliation, provided that their contributions meet the criteria for the nominated category. When a member receives individual recognition, the corresponding bonus points under Section 5 shall be awarded to the member's own House, not to the House whose embodied value aligns with the award category.

Section 3. Nomination and Selection Process.

- (1) Any active member of the Society may nominate a fellow member for individual recognition by submitting a Nomination Form directly to the Secretary of Internal Affairs for the attention of the Selection Committee. The form must include: the nominee's name and House; the category under which nomination is made; a statement of justification with specific examples of the nominee's contributions; and supporting documentation such as outputs, testimonials, or evidence of impact. Nominations must be submitted within the first four weeks of the Second Semester for annual recognition, or within two weeks of a special recognition cycle if declared by the High Council.
- (2) Upon receipt of a nomination, the Secretary of Internal Affairs shall verify the eligibility of the nominee within seven (7) calendar days. Verification shall confirm that the nominee is an active member in good standing and that the submission meets the documentation requirements. The Secretary of Internal Affairs shall not evaluate the merit of the nomination but shall ensure procedural compliance. If eligible, the nomination shall be forwarded to the Selection Committee. If ineligible, the nominator shall be notified in writing with reasons for disqualification.
- (3) A Selection Committee shall be convened for each recognition cycle, composed of: the High Council President (non-voting chair); one official from each of the four High Council offices (Internal Affairs, Public Affairs, Finance and Resource Management, External Affairs), appointed by the President; and one senior member from each House, nominated by their respective House Chancellor and approved by the Council of House Chancellors. The Selection Committee shall review all eligible nominations and select recipients by majority vote. Deliberations shall be confidential, and decisions shall be based solely on the merits of the nomination materials.
- (4) If a member of the Selection Committee is nominated for an individual award, they shall immediately disclose their nomination to the Committee Chair prior to deliberation. They

shall recuse themselves from all deliberations and voting pertaining to their own nomination. They shall not be present during the discussion of their candidacy. Their vote shall not be counted for that specific decision. They shall retain their seat for all other nominations where no conflict exists.

- (5) Selected recipients shall be announced at the Society Assembly Meeting following the Selection Committee's decision. Recognition shall include: a certificate of achievement bearing the Society seal and the recipient's name, category, and cycle; public acknowledgment in the Society's official communications; and, if applicable, a ceremonial pin or token representing the category. Recipients may also be featured in the Society Chronicle or official digital platforms, subject to their consent.

Section 4. Recognition Tiers and Cumulative Honor.

- (1) Individual recognition may be awarded at three tiers, based on the scope and impact of the member's contributions.
 - (a) *Emerging Contributor*. Awarded to members in their first or second semester of active membership who demonstrate promising potential and meaningful early contributions in a recognition category. This tier is non-exclusive; multiple members may receive this recognition per cycle.
 - (b) *Distinguished Member*. Awarded to members who have consistently demonstrated excellence in a recognition category over at least two semesters, with documented impact on their House or the Society. This tier is limited to one recipient per category per annual cycle.
 - (c) *Society Fellow*. Awarded to members who have made exceptional, Society-wide contributions across multiple categories or over an extended period (minimum three semesters), and whose work has significantly advanced the Society's mission. This is the highest individual honor; it shall be awarded only when the Selection Committee unanimously agrees that a nominee's contributions merit this distinction. A Society Fellow may be recognized only once per member.
- (2) A member who receives recognition at a lower tier in one cycle remains eligible for a higher tier in subsequent cycles. Recognition is cumulative in honor but not in privilege; higher tiers do not grant additional governance rights or material benefits beyond those stated in Section 1.

Section 5. Individual Achievements and House Points.

To maintain alignment with the House-focused competition framework, individual recognition shall not award points directly to the individual. However, when a member receives individual

recognition under this Framework, their House shall earn bonus points under Section 10(3) of the House Point System as follows: Emerging Contributor: five (+5) bonus points; Distinguished Member: ten (+10) bonus points; Society Fellow: fifteen (+15) bonus points. These points are cumulative with other bonus point opportunities and shall be posted to the Master House Point Ledger by the Secretary of Internal Affairs within three business days of the recognition announcement.

Section 6. Tracking, Privacy, and Transparency.

- (1) The Secretary of Internal Affairs shall maintain a confidential Individual Recognition Ledger recording all nominations, endorsements, selections, and recognitions. This Ledger shall include: nominee name and House; category and tier; nomination materials summary; Selection Committee decision; and date of recognition. All Society members shall have the right to view the list of recognized individuals and their categories, but shall not have access to confidential nomination materials or deliberation notes without the consent of the individuals involved. Recognized members may request a copy of their recognition record for personal or professional use.
- (2) When a member receives recognition in a category not aligned with their House's embodied value, the Individual Recognition Ledger shall note both the recipient's House and the award's aligned House for statistical and historical purposes. This notation shall not affect point allocation, which shall always credit the recipient's own House per Section 5.

Article III.

THE DEBATE LEAGUE

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

The Debate League is established as a merit-based framework to identify, select, and support the Society's designated representatives in external competitions. This Article operates alongside the House Point System (Article I) and the Individual Recognition Framework (Article II). Membership in the Debate League signifies that a member has earned the Society's commitment to provide for their competitive needs when representing Benguet State University in external tournaments. This framework is founded on the principle that excellence in Society and House debate activities shall be rewarded with institutional support for external representation.

Section 2. Individual Debate Point System.

- (1) Every active member of the Society shall have an Individual Debate Point tally tracked separately from House Points and Individual Recognition Awards. Individual Debate Points shall be accumulated based on competitive performance in Society-wide debates and House-wide debates approved by the High Council for point eligibility.
- (2) Specific criteria for earning Individual Debate Points, including point values for participation, match wins, speaker awards, tournament placements, and other performance metrics, shall be detailed in Annex A: Debate Performance Criteria.
- (3) Individual Debate Points are cumulative within an academic year. Points shall reset to zero (0) at the start of each new academic year to ensure fair semesterly selection for the Debate League.
- (4) Individual Debate Points under this Article are distinct from points awarded under Article I (House Point System) and Article II (Individual Recognition Framework). Points awarded under this Section are solely for determining Debate League eligibility and do not constitute honorary awards or House bonuses under other Articles.

Section 3. Composition and Selection of the Debate League.

- (1) The Debate League shall be composed of the eight (8) members with the highest cumulative Individual Debate Point totals at the end of each semester.
- (2) Selection shall occur on the last day of the semester. The Secretary of Internal Affairs (Point Keeper) shall:
 - (a) Publish provisional standings two (2) weeks prior to the end of the semester;

- (b) Allow three (3) calendar days for members to verify their point totals and report discrepancies in writing;
 - (c) Submit the final ranked list to the High Council President for certification.
- (3) Tie-Breaking Sequence: In the event of a tie for the eighth (8th) position, the following criteria shall apply in order:
 - (a) Highest number of Best Speaker awards received in Society-wide or House-wide debates during the semester;
 - (b) Highest placement in Society-wide debate tournaments;
 - (c) Highest participation rate in eligible debate activities;
 - (d) If still tied, the winner shall be determined by drawing of lots conducted by the Society President.
- (4) Debate League membership shall be valid for the subsequent semester only. A member who becomes inactive, resigns from the Society, or receives a major disciplinary sanction during their term shall be removed from the Debate League. The next highest-ranking eligible member from the semester's final standings shall be promoted to fill the vacancy for the remainder of the term.

Section 4. Society Support for Debate League Members.

- (1) When a Debate League member is registered to compete in an external tournament representing Benguet State University, the Society shall provide for the following needs, subject to the availability of resources and prior coordination with the High Council:
 - (a) Official endorsement in the form of a certification letter bearing the Society seal and the member's name, tournament details, and capacity as Society representative;
 - (b) Access to the Society's case library, research materials, argument databases, and preparatory resources;
 - (c) Coordination assistance for tournament registration, credential submission, and logistical arrangements;
 - (d) Priority access to Society-organized pre-tournament workshops, practice debates, and strategy sessions;
 - (e) Mentorship support from senior members or alumni, when available;

- (f) Reimbursement or advance for tournament registration fees, transportation, or accommodation, subject to submission of official receipts and prior approval by the Director of Finance and Resource Management in accordance with Society financial policies.
- (2) Support under this Section is contingent upon:
- (a) The tournament being recognized by the High Council as a legitimate external competition;
 - (b) The member submitting a Request for Support Form at least seven (7) days prior to the tournament, detailing anticipated needs and estimated costs;
 - (c) The member agreeing to submit a post-tournament report documenting their performance and outcomes, to be filed with the Secretary of Internal Affairs within seven (7) days of the tournament's conclusion.
- (3) The Society's obligation to provide support is not a guarantee of funding for all expenses. When resources are limited, the High Council shall prioritize support based on: (a) the tournament's prestige and relevance to the Society's mission; (b) the member's standing within the Debate League; and (c) the reasonableness and necessity of the requested support. Decisions regarding resource allocation shall be made transparently and communicated in writing to affected members.
- (4) Nothing in this Article shall prohibit any Society member or university student from independently participating in external tournaments using personal resources. However, participation without Debate League membership shall not entitle a member to the support mechanisms outlined in this Section.

Section 5. Rights and Responsibilities of Debate League Members.

- (1) Debate League members shall have priority nomination when the Society is allocated a limited number of slots for an external tournament.
- (2) Debate League members shall serve as mentors to novice members and may be assigned to lead training sessions or case-building workshops for their respective Houses.
- (3) Debate League members are expected to maintain a standard of conduct befitting the Society's representatives. Repeated minor disciplinary sanctions (two or more in a semester) or any major disciplinary sanction shall result in immediate review and potential removal from the Debate League by the High Council.
- (4) Debate League members shall maintain an active participation rate. Failure to participate in any Society-wide or House-wide debate activity for a continuous period of two (2)

months during their term, without valid reason approved by the High Council, may result in removal from the League.

Section 6. Tracking and Transparency.

- (1) The Individual Debate Point Ledger shall be maintained in digital format by the Secretary of Internal Affairs. The Ledger shall record the date, member name, House, points added, running total, and specific activity or reason for each transaction.
- (2) All Society members shall have view access to the Individual Debate Point Ledger through the Society's official online platform. Edit access shall be restricted to the Secretary of Internal Affairs only.
- (3) Standings shall be updated within three (3) business days following each processed point transaction. A summary of the top ten (10) individual performers shall be presented monthly at the Society Assembly Meeting.
- (4) The High Council shall publish a semesterly report detailing: (a) the final Debate League roster; (b) a summary of Society support provided to League members for external tournaments; and (c) the competitive outcomes achieved by League members. This report shall be presented at the first Society Assembly Meeting of the following semester.

Section 7. Amendment and Review.

- (1) This Debate League framework may be amended through the process outlined in Article IX. The framework shall be reviewed annually alongside the House Point System and Individual Recognition Framework.
- (2) Amendments concerning procedural or administrative matters shall take effect immediately. Amendments concerning point values, Debate League selection criteria, member rights, or Society support obligations shall take effect at the start of the next semester.
- (3) Annex A: Debate Performance Criteria may be updated by majority vote of the High Council with notice to members, provided that such updates do not retroactively alter point values for activities already completed.

Section 8. Transitory Provision.

Upon adoption of this Article, the first selection for the Debate League shall occur at the end of the current semester. Individual Debate Points accumulated prior to adoption may be counted toward the inaugural selection if they derive from activities that would qualify under Annex A. The High Council shall ratify Annex A within thirty (30) days of this Article's adoption.

Article IV.

MEETINGS AND DELIBERATIVE PROCEDURES

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

This Article establishes operational procedures for Society meetings and decision-making processes. It implements the meeting requirements under Article 8 of the Constitution and provides a simplified parliamentary framework based on Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised, adapted for accessibility and efficiency. This Article does not alter constitutional quorum requirements, voting thresholds, or member rights, but specifies administrative workflows to facilitate their exercise. All proceedings shall prioritize clarity, inclusivity, and productive deliberation over procedural complexity.

Section 2. Types of Meetings.

- (1) *Society Assembly Meeting.* A gathering of all active Society members, convened monthly as mandated by Article 12, Section 1 of the Constitution. General Meetings shall:
 - (a) Receive reports from the High Council and Council of House Chancellors;
 - (b) Deliberate and vote on constitutional amendments, policy ratifications, and matters requiring member approval under Article 9, Section 2 of the Constitution;
 - (c) Present updates on the House Point System, Individual Recognition Framework, and Debate League selections;
 - (d) Provide an open forum for member questions, petitions, or proposals.
- (2) *High Council Meeting.* A gathering of High Council officers, convened at least once monthly. High Council Meetings shall focus on executive coordination, policy implementation, and preparation of reports for Society Assemblies.
- (3) *Council of House Chancellors Meeting.* A gathering of the four House Chancellors and the Vice President (as Presiding Officer), convened as needed to deliberate on policy propositions, point system amendments, or inter-House matters.
- (4) *House Council Meeting.* A gathering of a House's internal officers, convened according to each House's internal schedule but reported to the Secretary of Internal Affairs for Society-wide coordination. House Council Meetings shall focus on internal governance, member development, and preparation of House-level reports.
- (5) *House Assembly Meeting.* A gathering of all members of a single House (including Executive Interns and Full Members), convened at least once per semester or as needed by the House Chancellor. House Assemblies shall:

- (a) Receive reports from the House Council on activities, finances, and upcoming initiatives;
 - (b) Provide a forum for House members to propose ideas, raise concerns, or nominate peers for recognition;
 - (c) Deliberate and vote on House-level matters that require member input, such as amendments to the House Membership Policy or selection of House representatives for Society-wide committees;
 - (d) Foster House identity, camaraderie, and alignment with the House's embodied value.
- (6) *Special Meeting*. Any meeting convened outside the regular schedule to address urgent matters. Special Meetings require: (a) a written request signed by at least twenty-five percent (25%) of active members (for Society Assembly Meetings) or House members (for House Assemblies), or (b) a resolution by the High Council, Council of House Chancellors, or relevant House Council; and (c) at least forty-eight (48) hours' notice to all entitled participants unless waived by unanimous consent.

Section 3. Notice and Agenda.

- (1) Written notice of any Society Assembly Meeting, High Council Meeting, Council of House Chancellors Meeting, or House Assembly shall be distributed through the Society's official digital platform at least seventy-two (72) hours prior to the meeting. Notice shall include: date, time, venue or virtual link, proposed agenda, and any pre-meeting materials requiring review.
- (2) Any member may submit an agenda item for a General Meeting or House Assembly by sending a written request to the Executive Secretary (for Society meetings) or House Secretariat Director (for House Assemblies) at least forty-eight (48) hours prior to the meeting. The request must include: a clear title, brief description (maximum 100 words), and the desired outcome (discussion, information, or vote). The relevant Secretary shall compile agenda items in consultation with the Presiding Officer and distribute the final agenda with the meeting notice.
- (3) At the start of each meeting, the Presiding Officer shall present the proposed agenda. Members may move to add, remove, or reorder items by majority vote. Once adopted, the agenda shall guide the meeting unless amended by majority vote.

Section 4. Presiding Officer and Meeting Conduct.

- (1) The following officers shall serve as the designated Presiding Officer for each type of meeting:
 - (a) Society Assembly Meetings and High Council Meetings: The President;
 - (b) Council of House Chancellors Meetings: The Vice President;
 - (c) House Assemblies and House Council Meetings: The House Chancellor.
- (2) If a designated Presiding Officer knows in advance that they will be absent from a scheduled meeting:
 - (a) They shall provide written notice of their absence to the Executive Secretary (for Society-wide meetings) or House Secretariat Director (for House meetings) at least forty-eight (48) hours prior to the meeting;
 - (b) If the Vice President or the second-in-rank officer is also absent, the Presiding Officer shall designate in writing a qualified active member in good standing to serve as temporary chair for that specific meeting only;
 - (c) The designation shall include the name of the temporary chair, the meeting date and type, and the scope of authority granted (which shall be limited to presiding over that meeting only);
 - (d) The Executive Secretary or House Secretariat Director shall notify all entitled participants of the absence and the designated temporary chair at least twenty-four (24) hours prior to the meeting.
- (3) If the designated Presiding Officer is absent from a scheduled meeting and has not complied with the advance designation requirement under subsection (2):
 - (a) The meeting shall not proceed with substantive business or binding votes;
 - (b) Any member present may move to reschedule the meeting to a later date;
 - (c) A motion to reschedule shall require a second and pass by majority vote of members present;
 - (d) If a motion to reschedule is not made or fails to pass, the meeting shall stand adjourned without prejudice, and the Presiding Officer shall be required to issue a new notice for a rescheduled meeting within three (3) business days;
 - (e) No provisional or temporary chair shall be elected or appointed during the meeting itself.

(4) A temporary chair designated under subsection (2) shall have all the powers and duties of the regular Presiding Officer for that meeting only, including:

- (a) Maintaining order and ensuring respectful discourse;
- (b) Recognizing speakers fairly and managing time limits;
- (c) Stating motions clearly before debate;
- (d) Ensuring votes are conducted fairly and results announced;
- (e) Ruling on points of order using the simplified procedures in Section 6.

However, a temporary chair shall NOT:

- (a) Represent the Society externally or sign official documents requiring the President's or House Chancellor's signature;
- (b) Preside over elections for permanent officers or constitutional amendments;
- (c) Exercise veto power or other executive authorities reserved to the regular Presiding Officer by the Constitution;
- (d) Serve beyond the conclusion of that specific meeting.

(5) All members participating in any Society meeting shall:

- (a) Address all remarks through the Presiding Officer or temporary chair;
- (b) Avoid personal attacks, discriminatory language, or disruptive behavior;
- (c) Respect time limits for speakers as established by the Presiding Officer;
- (d) Comply with rulings of the Presiding Officer unless a point of order is successfully raised or an appeal is sustained;
- (e) Refrain from using electronic devices in a manner that disrupts proceedings, unless required for participation in a virtual or hybrid meeting.
- (f) Mandatory Wellness Breaks for Extended Meetings. Any Society meeting, House Assembly, or Council session that exceeds two (2) consecutive hours of continuous deliberation shall include a mandatory wellness break of no less than ten (10) minutes. Such breaks shall be scheduled at the discretion of the Presiding Officer to minimize disruption to substantive agenda items, and shall be used for rest, hydration, and brief personal respite to support member well-being and sustained engagement. The Presiding Officer shall be responsible for announcing

and enforcing compliance with this requirement, and may extend the break duration upon majority consent of members present if warranted by the intensity or duration of preceding deliberations. Failure to observe the mandatory break requirement shall not invalidate proceedings but may be raised as a point of order for corrective action in future sessions.

- (6) If a member engages in conduct that materially disrupts the meeting after being warned by the Presiding Officer, the Presiding Officer shall have the sole authority to order the member to leave the meeting for the remainder of that session. Such removal must be justified by specific grounds recorded in the minutes of the meeting and may be appealed through the disciplinary procedures under Article VI.

Section 5. Simplified Motion and Voting Procedures.

- (1) *Making a Motion.* Any member entitled to vote may propose action by stating: "I move to [clear action]." The motion must be seconded by another entitled member to be considered. The Presiding Officer shall then restate the motion clearly before debate.
- (2) *Debate on a Motion.* After a motion is stated, members may debate its merits. The Presiding Officer shall alternate recognition between speakers for and against the motion. Each speaker shall be limited to two (2) minutes per turn, with one (1) opportunity to speak again if time permits. Debate ends when: (a) no member seeks recognition; (b) a member moves the previous question (see Section 5(3)); or (c) the Presiding Officer determines debate has been sufficient.
- (3) *Voting on a Motion.* After debate closes, the Presiding Officer shall call for a vote. Voting methods shall be:
 - (a) *Vote by Hand:* The default method. The Presiding Officer asks those in favor to raise their right hand, holds for a clear count, then asks those opposed to raise their right hand, holds for a clear count, and announces the result. If the count is unclear or contested, the Presiding Officer may order a second count or proceed to a Rising Vote.
 - (b) *Rising Vote:* Used for close hand votes, when requested by any two members, or for votes requiring a supermajority. Members stand to be counted. The Presiding Officer may appoint two (2) tellers to assist with counting if needed.
 - (c) *Secret Ballot:* Required for elections, disciplinary matters, or when requested by at least ten percent (10%) of members present.

A motion passes by majority vote unless the Constitution specifies a higher threshold. The Presiding Officer may vote only to break a tie.

The following motions are recognized for efficiency:

- (a) *Main Motion*: Proposes substantive action (requires second, debatable, amendable, majority vote).
 - (b) *Amend*: Proposes a change to a pending motion (requires second, debatable only on the amendment, majority vote).
 - (c) *Refer to Committee*: Sends a motion to a smaller group for study (requires second, debatable, majority vote).
 - (d) *Postpone Definitely*: Delays consideration to a specific time (requires second, debatable, majority vote).
 - (e) *Previous Question*: Ends debate and forces an immediate vote on the pending motion (requires second, not debatable, two-thirds vote to pass).
 - (f) *Point of Order*: Raises a procedural concern (no second, not debatable, Presiding Officer rules immediately).
 - (g) *Appeal*: Challenges a ruling of the Presiding Officer (requires second, debatable with Presiding Officer speaking first, majority vote to overturn).
 - (h) *Lay on the Table*: Temporarily sets aside a motion to address urgent business (requires second, not debatable, majority vote).
- (4) *Reconsideration*. A motion that has passed or failed may be reconsidered only if: (a) a member who voted on the prevailing side moves reconsideration; (b) the motion is made on the same day or the next scheduled meeting; and (c) it is seconded and passes by majority vote. Each motion may be reconsidered only once.

Section 6. Points of Order and Appeals (Simplified).

- (1) *Point of Order*. Any member may raise a point of order by stating "Point of Order" when they believe a rule has been violated. The member must briefly state the specific rule or procedure at issue. The Presiding Officer shall rule immediately, stating the basis for the decision. No debate is permitted on the point itself.
- (2) *Appeal*. Any member may appeal the Presiding Officer's ruling by stating "I appeal the decision of the Chair" immediately after the ruling. The appeal must be seconded. The Presiding Officer shall briefly explain their ruling, then the member appealing may briefly state their position. Debate is limited to these two statements unless the Presiding Officer permits one additional speaker per side. The assembly shall vote by majority to uphold or overturn the ruling. If the vote is tied, the Presiding Officer's ruling stands.

Section 7. Minutes and Documentation.

- (1) The Executive Secretary (for Society meetings) or House Secretariat Director (for House meetings) shall record minutes for each meeting. Minutes shall include: date, time, location, type of meeting, presiding officer, members present/absent, agenda items considered, motions made (with mover and seconder names), vote results, and key discussion points. Minutes shall not record verbatim debate or personal opinions.
- (2) Draft minutes shall be distributed to members within three (3) business days after the meeting. At the next meeting, the Presiding Officer shall call for corrections and approval. Minutes are approved by majority vote. Once approved, minutes become the official record and may only be corrected by a subsequent motion to amend the record.
- (3) Approved minutes shall be posted to the Society's official digital platform within five (5) business days of approval. Members shall have view access to all approved minutes. Draft minutes and unapproved records shall remain confidential until formally adopted.

Section 8. Quorum and Participation.

- (1) *Quorum Requirement.* As mandated by Article 12, Section 3 of the Constitution, a quorum for any Society meeting shall be a majority of officers and members. For purposes of this provision, 'members' shall mean active members as defined in Article I, Section 2(2) of these Rules.
- (2) *Quorum Verification.* At the start of each meeting, the Presiding Officer shall verify quorum through a roll call or digital attendance check. If quorum is not present, the meeting may proceed for discussion only; no binding votes may be taken until quorum is achieved.
- (3) *Participation Rights.* Only active members in good standing may make motions, second motions, or vote. Executive Interns may participate in debate at House Assemblies and Society Assembly Meetings but may not vote on constitutional amendments, officer elections, or House policy changes until elevated to Full Member status per Article 5 of the Constitution.

Section 9. Virtual and Hybrid Meetings.

- (1) Meetings may be conducted wholly or partially via virtual platform when approved by the High Council, relevant House Council, or when necessitated by extraordinary circumstances. The Presiding Officer shall ensure the platform allows for:
 - (a) clear audio/video for all participants;

- (b) real-time recognition of speakers;
- (c) secure voting mechanisms; and
- (d) recording capability for minute-taking.
- (e) Emergency Virtual Quorum Protocols. In circumstances of institutional closure, public health emergency, natural disaster, or other extraordinary conditions that prevent physical convening, meetings may be convened virtually under emergency quorum procedures. For such emergency virtual sessions, a valid quorum shall require the verified participation of at least fifty percent(50%) of entitled members through authenticated digital means, provided that:
 - (i) the Presiding Officer has issued a formal declaration of emergency with written justification;
 - (ii) all participating members are confirmed present through platform verification or roll call; and
 - (iii) the emergency justification, quorum verification method, and participation record are documented in the official minutes of the meeting.

Any action taken under emergency virtual quorum shall be ratified by a physical quorum within fourteen (14) calendar days of the restoration of normal convening capacity, failing which such action shall be deemed advisory only and subject to re-deliberation. These emergency protocols shall not alter the constitutional quorum requirements under Article 12, Section 3 of the Constitution, but shall provide an administrative mechanism for their application during extraordinary circumstances.

- (2) Members participating virtually shall have the same rights to speak, make motions, second, and vote as those present in person. The Presiding Officer shall manage recognition to ensure virtual participants are not disadvantaged.
- (3) If technical issues prevent a member from participating, they may request a brief recess to resolve the issue. If a quorum is lost due to technical disconnections, the meeting shall recess until quorum is restored or be adjourned to a later time.

Article V.

FINANCIAL AND RESOURCE MANAGEMENT PROTOCOLS

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

This Article establishes operational procedures for the management of Society-wide and House-level financial resources, assets, and logistical support. It implements the fiscal authority provisions under Article 7 and Article 8, Sections 9–11 of the Constitution, and provides detailed workflows to ensure transparency, accountability, and sustainability. This Article does not alter constitutional thresholds for fee-setting, budget approval, or audit requirements, but specifies administrative processes to facilitate their exercise. All financial and resource management shall align with the Society's principles under Article 3, particularly Sections 5 (honesty and ethical conduct) and 10 (education as empowerment).

Section 2. Classification of Resources.

- (1) *Society-Wide Resources.* Resources managed by the High Council for the benefit of the entire Society, including:
 - (a) *The General Fund:* Membership dues, tournament revenues, external grants, and donations collected at the Society level;
 - (b) *Society Assets:* Equipment, materials, digital platforms, or intellectual property owned by the Society as a whole;
 - (c) *Central Logistics:* Venue bookings, transportation, or services procured for Society-wide events.
- (2) *House Resources.* Resources managed by a House Council for the benefit of its members, including:
 - (a) *House Treasury:* Funds raised through House-specific initiatives, allocated Society bonuses, or House-level membership contributions;
 - (b) *House Assets:* Equipment, materials, or creative works owned or maintained by a specific House;
 - (c) *House Logistics:* Resources procured for House Assemblies, House-led initiatives, or House-specific representation.
- (3) *Distinction and Autonomy.* House Resources shall remain under the exclusive management of the respective House Council, subject to the reporting requirements under Section 7. Society-Wide Resources shall be managed by the Office of Financial and Resource Affairs (OFRA) under the oversight of the High Council. No House shall

commingle Society-Wide and House Resources without prior written approval from the President and the Council of House Chancellors.

Section 3. Budget Preparation and Approval.

(1) *Society-Wide Budget.*

- (a) Timeline: The OFRA shall draft the Annual Society Budget at least thirty (30) days prior to the start of each academic year.
- (b) Consultation: The draft budget shall be circulated to all House Councils and High Council offices for input at least twenty-one (21) days prior to submission.
- (c) Approval Process: The final budget shall be presented to the Council of House Chancellors for deliberation. Adoption requires: (a) a majority vote of the Council of House Chancellors; and (b) the concurrence of the President.
- (d) Publication: The approved budget shall be posted to the Society's official digital platform within five (5) business days of adoption.

(2) *House Budget.*

- (a) Timeline: Each House Council shall draft its Semester House Budget at least fourteen (14) days prior to the start of each semester.
- (b) Approval Process: The budget shall be adopted by majority vote of the House Council and approved by the House Chancellor.
- (c) Reporting: A copy of the approved House Budget shall be submitted to the OFRA within three (3) business days of adoption for consolidation into the Society-wide financial overview.

(3) *Emergency or Supplemental Budgets.* Requests for funds outside the approved budget may be submitted via a Supplemental Budget Request Form. Approval requires: (a) justification of urgency or unforeseen need; (b) endorsement by the relevant House Chancellor or High Council Secretary; and (c) approval by the President for Society-wide requests or the House Chancellor for House-level requests.

(4) *Mandatory House Resource Consolidation.* In accordance with Constitution Article 7, Section 2(10), each House Council shall submit a Financial Reconciliation Report to the Office of Financial and Resource Affairs (OFRA) within fourteen (14) calendar days following the end of each semester. The House shall remit twenty percent (20%) of its unrestricted semester-end surplus to a centralized Society Sustainability Fund. Remittance shall be completed within seven (7) business days of OFRA's verification of

the House Financial Report. The remaining eighty percent (80%) shall be retained under the exclusive management of the House Council. OFRA shall maintain a public ledger of all consolidated funds, and the High Council shall issue a semi-annual utilization report to the Society Assembly.

Section 4. Disbursement and Reimbursement Procedures.

(1) *Authorization Thresholds.*

- (a) *Minor Disbursements* (up to ₱500): May be authorized by the relevant House Chancellor or High Council Secretary with prior budget allocation.
- (b) *Standard Disbursements* (₱501–₱2,000): Require written approval from the President (for Society-wide) or House Chancellor (for House-level), with supporting documentation.
- (c) *Major Disbursements* (above ₱2,000): Require approval by majority vote of the Council of House Chancellors (for Society-wide) or House Council (for House-level), with prior budget allocation and detailed justification.

(2) *Reimbursement Process.*

- (a) *Submission*: Members seeking reimbursement shall submit a Reimbursement Request Form within seven (7) calendar days of incurring the expense. The form must include: official receipts, purpose of expense, budget line reference, and signature of the authorizing officer.
- (b) *Verification*: The OFRA (for Society-wide) or House Financial Director (for House-level) shall verify receipts and budget alignment within three (3) business days.
- (c) *Processing*: Approved reimbursements shall be processed within five (5) business days of verification. Payments shall be made via cash, bank transfer, or other documented method.

- (3) *Debate League Support*. Reimbursement or advance requests under Article III, Section 4(1)(f) shall follow the Standard or Major Disbursement process based on amount, with the additional requirement of a post-tournament report under Article III, Section 4(2)(c).

Section 5. Procurement and Asset Management.

(1) *Procurement Guidelines.*

- (a) Quotation Requirement: Purchases above ₱1,000 shall require at least two (2) price quotations from different suppliers, documented and attached to the purchase request.
- (b) Preference for Local and Sustainable: When feasible, priority shall be given to local suppliers, environmentally sustainable materials, and vendors aligned with the Society's values.
- (c) Approval Chain: All procurement requests shall follow the authorization thresholds in Section 4(1).
- (d) Sustainable Procurement Priorities. In furtherance of the Society's commitment to environmental stewardship under Article 3, Section 12 of the Constitution, all procurement requests shall incorporate sustainability considerations as follows:
 - (i) Threshold for Review. Purchases exceeding Two Thousand Pesos(₱2,000) shall require a brief Sustainability Impact Statement attached to the procurement request, documenting consideration of:
 - (A) availability of local or regional suppliers;
 - (B) environmental impact of materials or services, including waste generation and carbon footprint;
 - (C) potential for reusability, repairability, or end-of-life disposal; and
 - (D) alignment with the Society's operational sustainability goals.
 - (ii) Priority Criteria. When evaluating suppliers or products of comparable cost and quality, preference shall be given to options that:
 - (A) source materials or labor from local Benguet communities or Philippine-based enterprises;
 - (B) utilize recycled, recyclable, biodegradable, or low-impact materials;
 - (C) demonstrate durability and potential for extended use or repurposing; or
 - (D) offer take-back, refurbishment, or responsible disposal programs.
 - (iii) Exemption Provisions. The Sustainability Impact Statement requirement shall not apply to:

- (A) emergency procurements necessary to ensure member safety or continuity of essential operations;
- (B) purchases where no sustainable alternative is reasonably available within the required timeframe or budget;
- (C) items procured through University-mandated vendors or centralized procurement systems; or
- (D) expenditures below the Minor Disbursement threshold under Section 4(1)(a).

A brief written justification citing the applicable exemption shall be included in the procurement record.

- (iv) **Implementation Guidance.** The Office of Financial and Resource Affairs shall maintain a non-exhaustive list of preferred sustainable suppliers and materials for reference by requesting officers. Sustainability considerations shall be weighed alongside cost, quality, and timeliness; no procurement shall be delayed or denied solely on sustainability grounds unless expressly required by Society policy or University regulation.

(2) Asset Inventory and Maintenance.

- (a) *Inventory Ledger:* The OFRA (for Society assets) and each House Financial Director (for House assets) shall maintain a digital Asset Inventory Ledger recording: item description, serial/identification number, date of acquisition, cost, custodian, condition, and location.
- (b) *Check-Out System:* Members borrowing Society or House assets shall sign a Check-Out Form acknowledging responsibility for care and return. Damaged or lost items shall be reported immediately; replacement costs may be assessed based on negligence.
- (c) *Annual Audit:* A physical inventory audit shall be conducted at the end of every semester. Discrepancies shall be reported to the High Council and relevant House Council for resolution.

Section 6. Income-Generating Projects and External Funding.

- (1) **Society-Wide Projects.** Income-Generating Projects (IGPs) managed at the Society level shall be proposed by any High Council office or House Council. Proposals shall include: project description, target revenue, budget, timeline, and risk assessment. Approval requires: (a) majority vote of the Council of House Chancellors; and (b) concurrence of

the President. Net proceeds shall be allocated to the General Fund unless otherwise specified in the approved proposal.

- (2) **House-Level Projects.** Houses may conduct IGPs independently. Proposals shall be approved by majority vote of the House Council and the House Chancellor. A copy of the approved proposal and post-project financial report shall be submitted to the OFRA for Society-wide transparency. Net proceeds shall remain with the House unless the project utilized Society-Wide Resources, in which case a proportional sharing agreement shall be established prior to launch.
- (3) **External Grants and Sponsorships.** All applications for external grants, sponsorships, or donations shall be coordinated through the Office of External Affairs. Agreements shall be reviewed by the President and, if affecting multiple Houses or Society-wide obligations, ratified by the Council of House Chancellors. Funds received shall be allocated per the agreement terms and documented in the appropriate ledger.

Section 7. Financial Reporting and Transparency.

- (1) *Monthly Financial Snapshot.* The OFRA shall publish a Monthly Financial Snapshot on the Society's official digital platform within ten (10) business days after the end of each month. The Snapshot shall include: opening balance, income received, expenses incurred, closing balance, and notable transactions (without revealing sensitive personal data). House-level summaries shall be included with House Chancellor approval.
- (2) *Semester Financial Report.* At the end of each semester, the OFRA shall prepare a comprehensive Semester Financial Report for presentation at the Society Assembly Meeting. The Report shall include: budget vs. actual comparison, category-wise expenditure analysis, asset inventory status, and recommendations for the next semester. Each House Council shall submit a parallel House Financial Report for inclusion.
- (3) *Annual Independent Review.* At the end of each academic year, the Council of House Chancellors shall appoint an Independent Review Committee composed of: (a) one senior member not serving in the High Council or any House Council; (b) one faculty adviser or University student affairs representative; and (c) one alumni member in good standing. The Committee shall review the Annual Financial Statements and issue a Report of Findings to the Society Assembly Meeting. The Committee shall have access to all financial records but shall maintain confidentiality of sensitive information.

Section 8. Prohibited Acts and Sanctions.

- (1) *Prohibited Acts.* The following acts are strictly prohibited:

- (a) *Commingling*: Using Society-Wide Resources for exclusive House benefit, or vice versa, without prior written approval;
 - (b) *Unauthorized Disbursement*: Spending funds without proper authorization or outside approved budget lines;
 - (c) *Falsification*: Submitting false receipts, inflating expenses, or misrepresenting financial data;
 - (d) *Personal Gain*: Using Society or House position, resources, or information for personal financial benefit;
 - (e) *Negligent Custody*: Failing to exercise reasonable care over Society or House assets, resulting in loss or damage.
- (2) *Sanctions*. Violations shall be addressed through the disciplinary procedures under Article VI. In addition to disciplinary sanctions, financial violations may result in: (a) restitution of misused funds; (b) suspension of financial privileges for the responsible officer or House; (c) mandatory financial management training; or (d) referral to University authorities if criminal conduct is alleged; and (e) expulsion from the Society.

Section 9. Loan Services

- (1) *Authority to Lend*. The Society may offer loan services to Houses or active members for approved Society-related activities.
- (2) *Prohibition on Borrowing*. The Society itself is prohibited from securing external loans or indebtedness that exceeds its current assets.
- (3) *Repayment Terms*. All loans must be paid within the academic year they were incurred. Installment payments may be an option subject to approval by the Office of Financial and Resource Affairs.
- (4) *Default*. Failure to repay loans within the stipulated period shall result in the suspension of financial privileges and may be treated as a Major Violation under Article VI.

Article VI.

DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURES AND DUE PROCESS IMPLEMENTATION

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

This Article establishes operational procedures for addressing alleged violations of the Society's Constitution, Rules and Procedures, House Charters, or Code of Conduct. It implements the due process rights guaranteed under Article 4, Sections 11-12 of the Constitution and the judicial authority of the High Tribunal under Article 10 of the Constitution. This Article does not alter constitutional rights, Tribunal composition, or substantive standards of conduct, but specifies administrative workflows to ensure fair, timely, and transparent resolution of disciplinary matters. All proceedings under this Article shall uphold the Society's principles under Article 3, particularly Sections 5 (honesty and ethical conduct), 7 (constructive competition), and 10 (education as empowerment).

Section 2. Jurisdiction and Classification.

(1) *Jurisdiction.*

- (a) House Councils shall have original jurisdiction over Minor Violations involving members of their respective House, as authorized under Article 7, Section 2(5) of the Constitution.
- (b) The High Tribunal shall have original and final jurisdiction over Major Violations involving serious breaches of the Constitution, Rules and Procedures, or Code of Conduct, as mandated under Article 10 of the Constitution.
- (c) The High Council may intervene in House-level proceedings only if a constitutional violation is alleged, if there is a conflict of interest within the House Council, or if the House Council requests assistance.

(2) *Classification of Violations.* Violations shall be classified as Minor or Major consistent with the definitions in Article I, Section 2(4)-(5) of these Rules:

- (a) *Minor Violations* include: failure to submit requirements, minor disrespect not disrupting activities, minor negligence in custody of assets, or first-time procedural non-compliance. Tardiness, unexcused absences, and attendance-related issues shall be handled through internal House administrative measures and shall not constitute a Minor Violation under this Article.
- (b) *Major Violations* include: dishonesty or falsification of records, harassment or intimidation, intentional disruption or sabotage, discrimination, repeated Minor

Violations after warning, misappropriation of funds, or acts bringing significant disrepute to the Society or University.

- (3) *Initial Classification.* The Office of Internal Affairs (OIA) shall make an initial classification of a reported violation within three (3) business days of receipt of a complaint. This classification is provisional and subject to review by the adjudicating body (House Council or High Tribunal).

Section 3. Reporting and Preliminary Review.

- (1) *Filing a Complaint.* Any active member may report an alleged violation by submitting a written Complaint Form to the Office of Internal Affairs (for Society-wide/Major violations) or the relevant House Council's Office of Internal Affairs (for House-level/Minor violations) within fourteen (14) calendar days of the incident or discovery thereof.
- (2) *Contents of Complaint.* The form must include: the name and House of the accused member (Respondent); date, time, and location of the alleged incident; specific provision(s) alleged to be violated; a factual description with supporting evidence or witness information; and the complainant's signature.
- (3) *Preliminary Review.* Upon receipt, the OIA or House Internal Affairs Director shall conduct a preliminary review within three (3) business days to determine: (a) sufficiency in form and substance; (b) proper classification (Minor or Major) per Section 2(2); and (c) jurisdiction. If insufficient, the complainant may amend within five (5) days. If sufficient, the matter shall proceed to adjudication.
- (4) *Notice to Respondent.* The Respondent shall be notified in writing within two (2) business days of the determination of sufficiency. The notice shall include: a summary of allegations, specific provisions implicated, classification, the adjudicating body, and a statement of their rights under Article 4 of the Constitution and this Article.

Section 4. Adjudication of Minor Violations (House Council).

- (1) *Procedure.* House Councils shall conduct hearings for Minor Violations within seven(7) calendar days of the Respondent's notification. Proceedings shall be informal but documented, and shall guarantee the Respondent's rights to written notice, to be heard, to present evidence, and to receive a written decision. The strict public trial and compulsory process requirements of Article 4, Section 11 of the Constitution shall not apply to these House-level administrative proceedings.

- (2) *Rights of the Respondent.* The Respondent shall have the right to: (a) receive notice of charges; (b) be present and heard; (c) present evidence and witnesses; (d) be accompanied by a Society member advisor; and (e) receive a written decision.
- (3) *Mandatory Reporting to Society OIA.* Within three (3) business days of a finalized sanction, the House Internal Affairs Director shall transmit a copy of the Decision and Sanction Order to the Society Office of Internal Affairs (OIA). This submission is mandatory for the sanction to be considered executory. The Society OIA shall record the sanction in the Society Disciplinary Ledger and instruct the Point Keeper to apply the corresponding House Point deduction under Article I, Section 3(4).
- (4) *Sanctions.* Sanctions for Minor Violations may include: (a) verbal or written warning; (b) required community service within the House (up to ten (10) hours); (c) temporary suspension from House activities (up to two (2) weeks); or (d) point deductions to the House under Article I, Section 3(4).
- (5) *Appeal.* Decisions may be appealed to the High Council's Office of Internal Affairs within five (5) calendar days on grounds of procedural error or disproportionate sanction. The OIA shall review and render a decision within seven (7) business days.
- (6) *Confidential Whistleblower Disclosure and Anti-Retaliation Protection.*
- (a) Any member who has knowledge of a Minor Violation sanction that was not reported to the Society Office of Internal Affairs, or who has knowledge of any misconduct, ethical violation, or administrative malfeasance within the Society, may file a Confidential Disclosure Form directly with the Society Office of Internal Affairs or the Society Chief Adviser. Such disclosures shall be accepted through secure, anonymous channels established by the Office of Internal Affairs to protect the identity of the disclosing member.
 - (b) *Anonymity Guarantee.* Members who submit disclosures in good faith shall have their identity protected to the fullest extent permitted by due process requirements. The Office of Internal Affairs and Chief Adviser shall implement procedural safeguards to prevent unauthorized disclosure of whistleblower identity, including redaction of identifying information in investigative records and limitation of access to disclosure materials to authorized adjudicating personnel only.
 - (c) *Good-Faith Standard.* Protection under this subsection shall extend to any member who reasonably believes, based on available information, that the reported conduct constitutes a violation of the Constitution, Rules and Procedures,

or Code of Conduct. A disclosure shall be deemed made in good faith unless proven to be knowingly false or made with malicious intent.

(d) **Retaliation Prohibited.** Any act of retaliation, intimidation, harassment, adverse membership action, or other adverse treatment directed against a member for making a good-faith disclosure under this Section shall constitute a Major Violation under Article I, Section 2(5) of these Rules. Retaliation shall include, but not be limited to: exclusion from Society activities, denial of opportunities or benefits, unwarranted disciplinary action, public disparagement, or creation of a hostile environment.

(e) **Sanctions for Retaliation.** A finding of retaliation under this Section shall result in:

- (i) immediate provisional suspension of the retaliating member pending final adjudication;
- (ii) a mandatory fifteen-point (-15) deduction to the retaliating member's House under Article I, Section 3(4)(b); and
- (iii) eligibility for sanctions under Section 5(6), including removal from office, probation, or recommendation for expulsion.

The Office of Internal Affairs shall prioritize investigation of retaliation complaints and shall report findings to the High Tribunal for expedited adjudication.

(f) **Preservation of Due Process.** Nothing in this Section shall impair the Respondent's constitutional rights under Article 4 of the Constitution, including the right to confront accusers and present evidence. In cases where whistleblower anonymity conflicts with due process requirements, the High Tribunal may order limited disclosure of identifying information strictly necessary for fair adjudication, subject to protective orders limiting further dissemination.

Section 5. Adjudication of Major Violations (High Tribunal).

(1) *Constitutional Composition.* Proceedings for Major Violations shall be conducted by the High Tribunal as constituted under Article 10 of the Constitution:

- (a) *Presiding Judge:* The Society President;
- (b) *Jury of the Pillars:* The four (4) House Chancellors;
- (c) *Tribunal Secretary:* The Executive Secretary of the High Council.

(2) *Adversarial Mandate.* In accordance with Article 10, Section 3 of the Constitution:

- (a) *Counsel for the Defense:* The Chancellor of the House to which the Respondent belongs shall act as defense counsel. If the Respondent is a member of the High Council, the Chancellor of the House to which the officer belongs shall act as Defense.
- (b) *Commission on Prosecution:* The remaining three (3) House Chancellors shall constitute the prosecution, representing the Society's interests.
- (c) *Mandatory Duty:* Service as Defense Counsel or Prosecutor is a Constitutional Obligation. Chancellors are required to participate in adjudications regardless of personal sentiment toward the Respondent, unless a formal conflict of interest is declared and approved by the Presiding Judge.
- (d) *Right to Counsel:* The Respondent may retain additional counsel (who must be a Society member or University-recognized legal aid) to assist the Defense Chancellor.

(3) *Forms of Address and Procedural Protocol.* To maintain decorum, clarity, and respect for the judicial nature of High Tribunal proceedings, the following forms of address and protocols shall be observed:

- (a) *Presiding Judge.* The Society President, serving as Presiding Judge, shall be addressed as "Your Honor" by all participants, including Chancellors, counsel, the Respondent, and observers.
- (b) *The Accused Party.* The member facing charges shall be formally referred to as the "Respondent" throughout all written submissions, oral arguments, and official records.
- (c) *Defense Counsel.* The House Chancellor representing the Respondent shall be addressed as "Counsel for the Defense" or "Defense Chancellor."
- (d) *Prosecution.* The three House Chancellors constituting the prosecution shall be collectively addressed as "The Commission on Prosecution" or individually as "Prosecuting Chancellor."
- (e) *Prosecution.* The three House Chancellors constituting the prosecution shall be collectively addressed as "The Commission on Prosecution" or individually as "Prosecuting Chancellor."
- (f) *Written Submissions.* All motions, briefs, and evidence submitted to the Tribunal shall use the formal titles specified above. The Tribunal Secretary shall return any

submission that fails to comply with this subsection for correction before docketing.

(4) *Trial Timeline.*

(a) *Pre-Trial Conference:* Shall be convened within seven (7) days of the Tribunal's docketing to establish timelines and exchange evidence.

(b) *Trial Proper:* Shall commence within fourteen (14) calendar days of the pre-trial conference.

(c) *Verdict:* Shall be rendered within seven (7) business days of the trial's conclusion.

(5) *Due Process Standards.* All Tribunal proceedings shall uphold Article 4, Sections 11-12 of the Constitution, including: presumption of innocence, right to confront witnesses, privilege against self-incrimination, and speedy trial. The Presiding Judge shall ensure these rights are protected throughout.

(6) *Sanctions.* Sanctions for Major Violations may include:

(a) formal reprimand;

(b) suspension from Society activities (up to one (1) semester);

(c) removal from office, the Debate League, or other positions;

(d) probation; or

(e) recommendation for expulsion to the society, subject to ratification under Article 9, Section 2 of the Constitution.

Point deductions under Article I, Section 3(4) shall automatically apply upon final verdict.

(f) *Mental Health Consideration in Sanction Determination.* In determining appropriate sanctions under this Section, the High Tribunal shall consider documented mental health factors presented by the Respondent or Defense Counsel, including but not limited to:

(i) professional evaluation or diagnosis from a licensed mental health provider;

(ii) evidence of acute psychological distress contemporaneous with the alleged misconduct; or

- (iii) documented history of mental health conditions that may have contributed to the Respondent's conduct.

Such considerations shall inform the Tribunal's assessment of culpability, intent, and rehabilitative potential, and may warrant modification of sanction type or duration to prioritize therapeutic intervention, probation with counseling requirements, or other restorative measures. However, mental health factors shall not excuse or justify misconduct that poses a risk to member safety, institutional integrity, or the rights of others. Sanctions imposed with mental health considerations shall maintain proportionality to the violation, uphold the Society's standards of conduct, and align with the rehabilitative purpose of disciplinary proceedings under Article 3, Section 13 of the Constitution. The Tribunal shall state in its written decision whether and how mental health factors influenced its sanction determination.

Section 6. Appeal and Re-Trial.

- (1) *Right to Appeal.* In accordance with Article 10, Section 5 of the Constitution, any party aggrieved by the High Tribunal's verdict reserves the right to a singular appeal.
- (2) *Re-Trial Procedure.* Upon filing a timely appeal within five (5) calendar days of the verdict:
 - (a) A Re-Trial shall be convened presided over by the Society's Chief Adviser.
 - (b) The Adviser shall sit as the presiding authority to review evidence and law.
 - (c) The adversarial structure (Defense Chancellor and Prosecution Chancellors) shall remain consistent with Section 5(2).
 - (d) The Adviser's decision shall be final, executory, and beyond further challenge.
- (3) *Effect of Appeal.* Filing an appeal shall not automatically stay the imposition of a sanction, unless the Presiding Judge or the Adviser expressly orders a stay pending resolution.

Section 7. Provisional Measures.

- (1) *Immediate Risk.* In cases involving alleged Major Violations that pose an immediate risk to member safety, Society integrity, or preservation of evidence, the President may impose provisional measures pending final adjudication.

- (2) *Types of Measures.* Measures may include: (a) temporary suspension from Debate League activities or external representation; (b) restriction from accessing Society resources; or (c) temporary relief from office duties (without removal).
- (3) *Duration.* Provisional measures shall not exceed fourteen (14) days and must be reviewed by the High Tribunal at its first session. The Respondent may request an expedited hearing to challenge the measure.

Section 8. Records, Confidentiality, and Restoration.

- (1) *Disciplinary Ledger.* The Society Office of Internal Affairs (OIA) shall maintain a confidential Society Disciplinary Ledger recording all complaints, hearings, decisions, and sanctions for both Minor and Major Violations.
- (2) *Access.* Access shall be restricted to the High Council, relevant House Chancellors, and the Respondent regarding their own record. However, the Point Keeper (Secretary of Internal Affairs) shall have full access to the Ledger for the sole purpose of applying House Point deductions under Article I.
- (3) *Confidentiality.* All proceedings shall be confidential to protect privacy. However, final decisions involving suspension, removal, or expulsion shall be summarized (without victim/witness details) and reported to the Society General Meeting for transparency.
- (4) *Expungement.* Sanction records shall be expunged one (1) year after the member's departure from the Society, unless the sanction involved expulsion or academic dishonesty.
- (5) *Restoration.* Members who have completed a sanction period and demonstrated rehabilitation may petition the High Council for restoration of privileges (e.g., Debate League eligibility, office candidacy). The petition shall include a statement of reflection and endorsements from two (2) Society members. The High Council shall review within fourteen (14) days.

Section 9. Checks and Balances

- (1) *Escalation.* While House Councils have original jurisdiction over Minor Violations, the High Council may intervene if a Minor Violation reveals patterns of systemic abuse or if the House Council fails to act within the prescribed timeline.
- (2) *Referral.* The High Tribunal may refer a Major Violation to a House Council for preliminary fact-finding if the violation originated within House activities, provided the House Council recuses itself from the final adjudication.

- (3) *Oversight*. The High Council retains the authority to review sanctions imposed by House Councils to ensure proportionality and consistency across the Society.

Section 10. Prosecution Recommendation

After the determination of sufficiency, the three prosecuting Chancellors shall review the case and forward to the Presiding Judge their recommended sanction for the Respondent. This recommendation shall be considered during deliberation but shall not bind the High Tribunal's final verdict.

Section 11. Membership Terms and Continuing Jurisdiction.

- (1) *Terms of Membership*. All Society members must sign a Terms and Conditions agreement upon admission.
- (2) *Continuing Jurisdiction*. Resignation from membership does not signify that the Debate Society no longer has jurisdiction over the member regarding cases they might have been involved in prior to resignation. If a member committed violations while active, even if they resign, they may still be called to the High Tribunal for their case. Sanctions may include permanent bans from re-admission or recognition.

Article VII.
THE PRESIDENTIAL CONCLAVE

Section 1. Declaration, Purpose, and Schedule.

- (1) *The Presidential Conclave.* The election of the Society President shall be conducted through a specialized deliberative body known as the “Presidential Conclave.” This process is designed to ensure that the Society President possesses the confidence, respect, and collaborative support of the House leadership, and to uphold the Society’s principles of reasoned dialogue, intellectual rigor, and constructive competition under Article 3 of the Constitution.
- (2) *Composition of Electors and Candidates.* The Conclave shall be composed exclusively of the four (4) sitting House Chancellors. Each Chancellor shall hold one (1) vote and shall simultaneously serve as a candidate for the Presidency.
- (3) *Eligibility.* Only sitting House Chancellors in good standing are eligible to be elected as Society President through this process. Upon filing for candidacy, a Chancellor acknowledges their willingness and availability to serve as Society President if elected by the Conclave.
- (4) *Exclusivity of Vote.* Pursuant to the exception provided in Article 11, Section 1 of the Constitution, the power to elect the President resides solely and strictly within the four (4) House Chancellors. No external officer, including the Vice President or President, shall possess voting rights, tie-breaking authority, or veto power over the Conclave's decision.
- (5) *Schedule of the Conclave.* The Presidential Conclave shall be conducted annually during the finals period of the Second Semester, as determined by the Benguet State University academic calendar. The High Council shall issue a formal Notice of Conclave at least fourteen (14) days prior to the scheduled date, specifying the venue, start time, and procedural reminders.

Section 2. The Presiding Officer and Oversight.

- (1) *Presiding Officer.* The outgoing Society President shall serve as the Presiding Officer of the Conclave. Their role shall be limited to:
 - (a) Overseeing the flow of proceedings and enforcing time limits;
 - (b) Ensuring adherence to the interrogation and voting protocols;
 - (c) Maintaining order and decorum during deliberations;

(d) Certifying the final vote count and proclamation.

The Presiding Officer shall not vote, interrogate, participate in candidate deliberations, or intervene in deadlocks.

(2) *Secretary of the Conclave.* The Vice President of the Society shall serve as the Secretary of the Conclave. They shall be responsible for:

- (a) Distributing and collecting ballots;
- (b) Recording vote tallies and procedural milestones;
- (c) Serving as the official timekeeper under Section 8;
- (d) Certifying the results and issuing the formal Proclamation of Election;
- (e) Maintaining the official Conclave Record.

The Vice President shall not possess voting rights or tie-breaking authority within the Conclave.

(3) *Seclusion.* During the interrogation and voting phases, the Conclave shall be in closed session. No external communication shall be permitted until a verdict is reached and the results are certified.

Section 3. Platform Presentation and Interrogation Proceedings.

(1) *Platform Presentation (Pre-Round).* Before interrogation rounds commence, each Chancellor-candidate shall be afforded a fifteen (15) minute period to present their platform, vision, and qualifications before the Conclave. Presentations shall be delivered in an order determined by drawing of lots. No interruptions or questions shall be permitted during this period.

(2) *Interrogation Rounds.* Following platform presentations, the Conclave shall proceed to structured interrogation rounds:

- (a) *Structure.* In each round, one Chancellor-candidate shall be designated as the Respondent. One (1) of the remaining three (3) Chancellors shall be designated as the Interrogator. The Interrogator shall have two (2) minutes to question the Respondent regarding their platform, judgement, or fitness for office.
- (b) *Cycle.* The interrogation shall cycle through all four Chancellor-candidates as Respondents. The assignment of Interrogators shall rotate to ensure equitable questioning. The Presiding Officer shall enforce the two-minute time limit strictly.

- (c) *Conduct.* Questions must be relevant, respectful, and aimed at assessing fitness for office. Personal attacks, discriminatory language, or disruptive behavior shall be grounds for immediate censure by the Presiding Officer.
- (3) *Post-Interrogation Deliberation.* After all four Chancellor-candidates have been interrogated in a round, the Conclave shall enter a brief closed deliberation period (maximum five (5) minutes) to reflect on the responses before proceeding to vote.

Section 4. Voting Protocol.

- (1) *The Proceed Vote.* Following each complete cycle of interrogation and deliberation, the Conclave shall conduct a vote on the following question: “*Shall the Conclave proceed to the Election by Secret Ballot?*”
- (2) *Threshold.* To proceed to the Election by Secret Ballot, the motion requires an affirmative vote of at least three (3) of the four (4) House Chancellors (supermajority).
- (3) *Outcomes.*
 - (a) *If the motion passes (3 or 4 votes):* The Conclave shall immediately proceed to Section 5 (Election by Secret Ballot).
 - (b) *If the motion fails (0, 1, or 2 votes):* The Conclave shall commence another full round of interrogation under Section 3(2), followed by another Proceed Vote under this Section. There is no limit to the number of cycles, provided the Conclave remains in session and the time limit under Section 8 has not been reached.
- (4) *Persistent Deadlock.* If the Conclave fails to achieve the two-vote threshold to proceed after five (5) complete cycles, the Conclave shall continue to conduct interrogation rounds and Proceed Votes until the threshold is met or the time limit under Section 8 is reached. No external officer shall intervene to break the deadlock.

Section 5. Election by Secret Ballot.

- (1) *Method.* Upon a successful Proceed Vote, the Conclave shall conduct the final election via secret ballot. The Secretary of the Conclave shall distribute blank ballots to the four (4) House Chancellors.
- (2) *Voting.* Each Chancellor shall write the name of their preferred candidate (which may include themselves) on the ballot. Ballots shall be collected, counted, and verified by the Secretary in the presence of the Presiding Officer.

(3) *Threshold for Election.* To be elected Society President, a candidate must secure a simple majority of at least two (2) affirmative votes.

(4) *Contingency for Ballot Deadlock.*

(a) *Inconclusive Ballot.* If no candidate secures at least two (2) votes in the first secret ballot, the ballot shall be deemed inconclusive.

(b) *Return to Interrogation.* Upon an inconclusive ballot, the Conclave shall return to Section 3 (Interrogation Proceedings) for another full round of interrogation.

(c) *Subsequent Voting.* Following the new interrogation round, the Conclave shall proceed to Section 4 (Proceed Vote). If the Proceed Vote passes, the Conclave shall conduct another Secret Ballot under this Section.

(d) *No External Tie-Breaker.* Under no circumstances shall the Vice President, President, or any external officer cast a tie-breaking vote. The decision must originate strictly from the four (4) House Chancellors through continued deliberation and voting.

Section 6. Contingency: Inability, Ineligibility, or Substitution of a Chancellor-Candidate.

(1) *Grounds for Substitution.* If a House Chancellor-candidate is unable to continue in the Conclave, is ineligible to run, or if elected, is unable to assume the Presidency due to special circumstances. The following grounds shall apply:

(a) Voluntary withdrawal or resignation filed in writing with the Presiding Officer;

(b) Disqualification due to ineligibility discovered mid-process;

(c) Incapacity due to health emergency, university sanction, or force majeure;

(d) Death or permanent inability to serve;

(e) *Graduating Status.* The Chancellor-candidate is a graduating student who will not be enrolled in the University for the subsequent academic year, unless expressly permitted by a High Council Resolution to serve a transitional term.

(2) *Procedure for Ineligibility or Substitution Before Conclave.* If a sitting House Chancellor is determined to be ineligible to run for President before the Conclave commences:

(a) *Notification.* The Presiding Officer shall notify the affected House Council in writing of the ineligibility.

- (b) *Succession Hierarchy*. The House Council shall have forty-eight (48) hours to identify a substitute candidate from within its own Council officers, in the following order of priority:
- (i) *First*: The House Vice Chancellor, provided they meet the constitutional qualifications for Society President under Article 8, Section 2(3);
 - (ii) *Second*: Any sitting House Council Director (e.g., Secretariat, Internal Affairs, External Affairs, Finance, Business, Public Affairs), provided they meet the constitutional qualifications for Society President under Article 8, Section 2(3).
- (c) *Special Nomination Assembly*. If all sitting House Council officers are ineligible or unable to serve as the substitute candidate, the House Council shall convene a Special Nomination Assembly within the same forty-eight (48) hour period.
- (i) The Assembly shall be open to all bona fide Full Members of that House;
 - (ii) House members may nominate eligible Full Members to serve as the House's representative-candidate in the Conclave;
 - (iii) Nominations must be seconded and approved by majority vote of House members present;
 - (iv) The nominated representative shall assume the candidacy and voting rights of the original Chancellor for the Conclave.
- (d) *Failure to Appoint*. If the House Council fails to appoint a substitute via Succession or Nomination Assembly within the timeframe, the seat shall be deemed vacant for the purposes of the Conclave, and the Conclave shall proceed with the remaining eligible Chancellors under Subsection (5).
- (3) *Procedure During Conclave*. If a Chancellor-candidate becomes unable to continue during the Conclave proceedings:
- (a) The Presiding Officer shall immediately suspend the Conclave;
 - (b) The respective House Council shall have twenty-four (24) hours to appoint a substitute following the Succession Hierarchy outlined in Subsection 2(b)-(c);
 - (c) The substitute shall assume the candidacy and voting rights of the original Chancellor for the remainder of the Conclave;

- (d) If the House Council fails to appoint a substitute via Succession or Nomination Assembly within the timeframe, the seat shall be deemed vacant for the purposes of the Conclave, and the Conclave shall proceed with the remaining eligible Chancellors under Subsection (5).
- (4) *Procedure Post-Election.* If the elected Chancellor is unable to assume the Presidency after proclamation but before assumption of office:
 - (a) The proclamation shall be held in abeyance;
 - (b) A new Conclave shall be convened within seven (7) days, composed of the remaining eligible House Chancellors or their duly nominated substitutes under Subsection (2);
 - (c) If fewer than three (3) Chancellors remain eligible, the succession protocols under Subsection (5) and (6) shall apply.
- (5) *Insufficient Quorum of Eligible Electors.* If, after exhausting the Succession Hierarchy and Nomination Assembly procedures, the number of eligible Chancellors remaining is insufficient to constitute a valid Conclave, the following protocols shall apply:
 - (a) *Three (3) or Four (4) Eligible Chancellors.* The Conclave shall proceed normally. The threshold for the Proceed Vote shall be reduced to two (2) affirmative votes and the threshold for election shall remain at two (2) affirmative votes.
 - (b) *Two (2) or Fewer Eligible Chancellors.* The Conclave shall be deemed unable to convene. The election process under this Article shall be terminated immediately. The succession protocols under Subsection (6) shall be triggered.
- (6) *Vice Presidential Succession.* If the Conclave is deemed unable to convene under Subsection (5)(b):
 - (a) *Eligibility Check.* The Society Vice President shall be assessed for eligibility to assume the Presidency under Article 8, Section 2(3) of the Constitution.
 - (b) *Condition for Assumption.* The Vice President shall assume the Presidency only if the outgoing Society President is ineligible to continue. If the outgoing President is eligible to continue, they shall retain the office until the next election cycle.
 - (c) *Proclamation.* If the Vice President assumes the Presidency, the Secretary of the Conclave shall issue a Proclamation of Succession rather than Election.
- (7) *Period of Discontinuation and Alumni Convention.* If the Conclave is unable to convene (Subsection (5)(b)) and the Vice President is ineligible to assume the Presidency (Subsection (6)):

- (a) *Declaration of Discontinuation.* The Society shall enter a Period of Discontinuation. All Society operations shall be suspended except for essential asset preservation and financial custody managed by the Office of Financial and Resource Affairs under the oversight of the Society Chief Adviser.
 - (b) *Alumni Convention.* Within thirty (30) days of the Declaration of Discontinuation, the Society Chief Adviser shall convene an Alumni Convention composed of bona fide Alumni Members in good standing.
 - (c) *Selection Protocol.* The Alumni Convention shall elect an Interim President through the following process:
 - (i) *Eligible Pool.* Only bona fide current or former members of the Society who meet the constitutional qualifications for President under Article 8, Section 2(3) of the Constitution shall be eligible for selection.
 - (ii) *Nomination.* Any Alumni Member in good standing may nominate an eligible candidate. Nominations must be seconded and approved by majority vote of Alumni Members present.
 - (iii) *Consent Requirement.* Before any nominee may be declared selected, the Society Chief Adviser shall formally notify the nominee in writing. The nominee shall have seven (7) calendar days to provide written consent to serve. If the nominee declines or fails to respond within the period, they shall be removed from consideration, and the Convention shall proceed to select another candidate.
 - (iv) *Selection Vote.* Upon receipt of written consent, the Alumni Convention shall conduct a final vote by secret ballot. A candidate must secure a majority of votes cast to be selected as Interim President.
 - (d) *Proclamation and Assumption.* Upon successful selection and confirmed consent, the Society Chief Adviser shall issue a Proclamation of Interim Presidency. The Interim President shall assume office immediately or on a date specified in the proclamation.
 - (e) *Term and Restoration.* The Interim President shall serve until a regular Presidential Conclave can be successfully conducted under this Article. Upon assumption of office by a regularly elected President, the Period of Discontinuation shall end, and Society operations shall resume under the direction of the High Council.
- (8) *Succession of the Vacated Chancellor Seat.* Upon a Chancellor assuming the Presidency (or being substituted under this Section), their position as House Chancellor shall be

deemed vacated. The respective House Council shall appoint an interim Chancellor in accordance with their House Charter within seven (7) days.

Section 7. Proclamation and Announcement.

- (1) *The Signal.* Upon the conclusion of a successful secret ballot vote, the Presiding Officer shall signal the end of the Conclave by striking the gavel three (3) times. The doors of the Conclave chamber shall then be opened to the Society Assembly.
- (2) *The Proclaimer.* The Vice President, acting as the Secretary of the Conclave, shall step forward to announce the result to the Society Assembly or via the Society's official digital platform.
- (3) *Formal Declaration.* The announcement shall be made using the following formal protocol:
 - (a) The Vice President shall state: "*Members of the Debate Society, the Presidential Conclave has concluded.*"
 - (b) The Vice President shall then declare: "*Habemus Praesidem.*" (We have a President.)
 - (c) The Vice President shall conclude with: "*By the authority vested in the Council of House Chancellors and under the Constitution and the Rules and Procedures of the Benguet State University - Debate Society, I proclaim the election of [Name of Elected President] of the House of [House Name] as the next President of the Society.*"
- (4) *Certification.* The results shall be documented in the Official Election Report, signed by the Presiding Officer and the Vice President, and filed with the Office of the Executive Secretary.

Section 8. Time Limit and Adjournment.

- (1) *Maximum Duration.* The Presidential Conclave shall not exceed four (4) hours (240 minutes), calculated from the moment the Presiding Officer declares the Conclave in session to the moment of Proclamation or adjournment. This time limit is absolute and includes all platform presentations, interrogation rounds, deliberation periods, voting procedures, and formal announcements.
- (2) *Time Allocation Breakdown.* To ensure efficient use of the allotted time, the following standard allocations shall apply per session:
 - (a) Opening Formalities and Drawing of Lots: Ten (10) minutes;

- (b) Platform Presentations (4 candidates $\times$ 15 minutes): Sixty (60) minutes (First Session Only);
 - (c) Each Complete Interrogation Cycle (4 respondents $\times$ 2 minutes interrogation + transitions + 5-minute deliberation + Proceed Vote): Twenty (20) minutes per cycle;
 - (d) Secret Ballot Election: Twenty (20) minutes for distribution, voting, counting, and verification;
 - (e) Proclamation and Closing Formalities: Fifteen (15) minutes.
- (3) *Timekeeping*. The Vice President, serving as Secretary of the Conclave, shall serve as the official timekeeper. They shall provide verbal warnings at the three (3) hour mark and the three-hour-thirty (3:30) minute mark. At the four (4) hour mark, the Presiding Officer shall immediately halt all proceedings, regardless of the stage of the Conclave.
- (4) *Mandatory Adjournment*. If the four (4) hour limit is reached before a President is elected and proclaimed:
- (a) The Presiding Officer shall immediately declare the Conclave adjourned until reconvened;
 - (b) All ballots, notes, deliberation records, and vote tallies from the session shall be sealed by the Secretary and secured by the Executive Secretary of the High Council.
 - (c) *Continuity of Progress*. All procedural progress, including completed interrogation rounds, vote tallies, and sealed ballots, shall carry over to the reconvened session. Platform Presentations under Section 3(1) shall not be repeated. The reconvened Conclave shall resume from the exact point of adjournment.
- (5) *Reconvening the Conclave*. Within forty-eight (48) hours of adjournment, the High Council shall convene to determine the date and time for reconvening the Conclave. The reconvened Conclave shall:
- (a) Be scheduled no later than seven (7) calendar days from the date of adjournment;
 - (b) Resume from the point of adjournment without repeating completed stages (Drawing of Lots, Platform Presentations);
 - (c) Be subject to a new four (4) hour time limit for the reconvened session.

- (d) *Emergency Succession*. If a reconvened Conclave fails to elect a President due to reaching the time limit a third time, or if the High Council fails to schedule a reconvened Conclave within the prescribed period, the succession protocols under Section (6)(6) and (6)(7) shall apply.

Section 9. Assumption of Office.

- (1) *Effectivity*. The elected President shall assume office immediately following the Proclamation, unless a specific transition date is set by the High Council.
- (2) *Oath*. The newly elected President shall take the Oath of Office administered by the Society Chief Adviser or the outgoing President during the next Society Assembly Meeting.

Section 10. Electoral Disputes.

- (1) *Grounds for Protest*. Any House Chancellor may file an electoral protest within three (3) days of the Proclamation on grounds of procedural violation, vote tampering, or eligibility issues.
- (2) *Adjudication*. Electoral protests shall be adjudicated by the High Tribunal, presided over by the Society Chief Adviser. The decision of the Tribunal shall be final and executory.
- (3) *Recall*. In the event that the election is nullified by the High Tribunal, a new Conclave shall be convened within fourteen (14) days following the same procedures outlined in this Article.

Article VIII.
RECORDS MANAGEMENT, TRANSPARENCY, AND INFORMATION ACCESS

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

This Article establishes operational procedures for the creation, classification, retention, access, and publication of Society records. It implements the right to information guaranteed under Article 4, Section 5 of the Constitution and provides detailed workflows to ensure transparency, accountability, and data protection. This Article does not alter constitutional rights, document custodianship under Article 7, or privacy protections, but specifies administrative processes to facilitate their exercise. All records management shall align with the Society's principles under Article 3, particularly Sections 5 (honesty and ethical conduct) and 10 (education as empowerment).

Section 2. Classification of Records.

- (1) *Public Records*. Records that shall be accessible to all Society members upon request, including:
 - (a) Approved minutes of Society Assembly Meetings, House Assemblies, and Council meetings;
 - (b) Finalized point standings under the House Point System (Article I), Individual Recognition Framework (Article II), and Debate League (Article III);
 - (c) Approved budgets, semester financial snapshots, and annual financial statements (subject to Section 7(3));
 - (d) Election results, certificates of proclamation, and post-election reports under Article VII;
 - (e) Final disciplinary decisions involving suspension, removal, or expulsion (summarized without victim/witness identifiers);
 - (f) The Constitution, Rules and Procedures, House Charters, and approved annexes.
 - (g) Activity Designs for both Society-wide and House-wide events;
 - (h) Loan transactions (subject to deliberation and privacy redactions);
- (2) *Restricted Records*. Records accessible only to authorized officers or upon demonstrated need, including:
 - (a) Draft minutes, unapproved reports, or provisional point postings;

- (b) Individual member contact information, academic records, or personal data not required for public disclosure;
 - (c) Internal deliberation notes, selection committee materials, or confidential nomination packages under Article II;
 - (d) Disciplinary complaint forms, investigation notes, or hearing transcripts not resulting in final sanctions;
 - (e) Financial records containing personal banking details, unreimbursed receipts, or sensitive vendor contracts.
- (3) *Confidential Records*. Records accessible only to the High Council, relevant House Councils, or adjudicating bodies, including:
- (a) Records involving pending disciplinary proceedings, appeals, or restoration petitions;
 - (b) Records containing legally privileged communications, attorney-client materials, or University-confidential submissions;
 - (c) Records whose disclosure would reasonably endanger member safety, compromise ongoing investigations, or violate University data privacy policies.
- (4) *Classification Authority*. The Executive Secretary, in consultation with the Director of Internal Affairs and relevant House Secretariat Directors, shall classify records upon creation. Misclassification may be appealed to the High Council.

Section 3. Retention Schedules and Custodianship.

- (1) *Retention Periods*. Records shall be retained according to the following minimum schedules:
- (a) Permanent: Constitution, Rules and Procedures, House Charters, ratified amendments, annual financial statements, election results, and House Cup winners.
 - (b) Ten (10) Years: Approved meeting minutes, finalized point ledgers, disciplinary decisions with sanctions, and major project reports.
 - (c) Five (5) Years: Draft documents, provisional reports, routine correspondence, and semester financial snapshots.
 - (d) One (1) Year: Temporary records, attendance sheets, unreimbursed receipts, and draft agendas.

- (e) *Immediate Expungement*: Personal data collected for specific, time-bound purposes (e.g., event registration) once the purpose is fulfilled, unless consent for retention is obtained.

(2) *Custodianship*.

- (a) *Society-Wide Records*: The Executive Secretary shall serve as the formal custodian of all Society-wide records under Article 8, Section 6 of the Constitution, with the Secretary of Internal Affairs maintaining operational ledgers under delegated authority.
- (b) *House-Level Records*: Each House Secretariat Director shall serve as custodian of House-specific records, with copies of required reports submitted to the Executive Secretary for Society-wide archiving.
- (c) *Digital Custodianship*: The Office of Public Affairs shall maintain the Society's official digital platform, with access permissions managed by the Executive Secretary.

- (3) *Transfer and Disposition*. Upon expiration of retention periods, records shall be: (a) archived permanently if designated; (b) securely destroyed if no longer needed, with a destruction log maintained; or (c) transferred to University archives if required by institutional policy. Destruction of any record classified as Permanent or involving disciplinary sanctions requires written approval from the High Council.

Section 4. Access Request Procedures.

- (1) *Request Submission*. Any active member may request access to Public or Restricted Records by submitting a written Access Request Form to the Executive Secretary (for Society-wide records) or relevant House Secretariat Director (for House records). The form must include: the requester's name and House, specific records sought, purpose of request, and preferred format (digital copy, in-person review, or summary).
- (2) *Processing Timeline*. The custodian shall respond to requests within five (5) business days. If granted, access shall be provided within three (3) business days of the response. If denied, the response shall state the specific ground for denial (e.g., confidential classification, privacy protection, pending proceeding) and the appeal process under Section 6.
- (3) *Access Methods*.
 - (a) *Digital Access*: Public Records shall be posted to the Society's official digital platform with view-only permissions. Restricted Records may be shared via secure, password-protected links with expiration dates.

- (b) *In-Person Review*: Requesters may review physical records at scheduled times in the presence of the custodian or designee. Photography or copying may be permitted at the custodian's discretion.
 - (c) *Summarized Access*: For records containing mixed public/confidential content, the custodian may provide a redacted version or factual summary that protects sensitive information.
- (4) *Fees*. No fee shall be charged for access to Public Records. Reasonable copying or printing costs may be charged for physical copies of Restricted Records, with prior notice to the requester.

Section 5. Publication and Proactive Disclosure.

- (1) *Mandatory Publications*. The following records shall be proactively published without request:
- (a) Monthly: House Point standings (Article I, Section 7), Debate League standings (Article III, Section 6), and financial snapshots (Article V, Section 7(1));
 - (b) Semesterly: Individual Recognition recipients (Article II, Section 6), Debate League support reports (Article III, Section 6(4)), and House financial reports (Article V, Section 7(2));
 - (c) Annually: House Cup results (Article I, Section 9), Annual Excellence Awards (Article I, Section 10(2)), election reports (Article VII), and the President's State of the Society Address summary.
- (2) *Publication Platform*. All mandatory publications shall be posted to the Society's official digital platform within the timelines specified in relevant Articles. The Office of Public Affairs shall ensure consistent formatting, accessibility, and archival of published materials.
- (3) *Notification*. Members shall be notified of new publications through the Society's official communication channels (e.g., group chat, email, announcement at General Meetings).

Section 6. Appeals and Dispute Resolution.

- (1) *Appeal Grounds*. A member may appeal a denial of access or classification decision on grounds of: (a) misclassification of a record; (b) unreasonable delay in processing; (c) over-redaction of a Public Record; or (d) violation of constitutional information rights under Article 4, Section 5.

- (2) *Appeal Process.* Appeals shall be submitted in writing to the High Council within five (5) calendar days of the denial or classification decision. The Council shall review the appeal within seven (7) business days, with the Executive Secretary providing the record and rationale for the original decision. The Council may uphold, modify, or reverse the decision by majority vote.
- (3) *Finality.* The High Council's decision on access appeals shall be final and executory, except where a constitutional violation is alleged, in which case the matter may be referred to the High Tribunal under Article 10 of the Constitution.

Section 7. Data Privacy and Protection.

- (1) *Personal Data Principles.* The Society shall collect, process, and store personal data in accordance with the following principles:
- (a) *Lawfulness and Transparency:* Data collection shall have a legitimate Society purpose, and members shall be informed of how their data will be used.
 - (b) *Purpose Limitation:* Data shall be used only for the purpose for which it was collected, unless additional consent is obtained.
 - (c) *Data Minimization:* Only data necessary for the stated purpose shall be collected.
 - (d) *Accuracy:* Reasonable steps shall be taken to ensure personal data is accurate and updated.
 - (e) *Storage Limitation:* Data shall not be retained longer than necessary for the stated purpose.
 - (f) *Integrity and Confidentiality:* Appropriate security measures shall protect data from unauthorized access, loss, or disclosure.
 - (g) *Digital Security Standards.* To operationalize the Integrity and Confidentiality principle under subsection (f), the Society shall implement the following technical and administrative safeguards:
 - (i) *Encryption and Approved Platforms.* All sensitive data, including personal contact information, disciplinary records, financial data, and confidential deliberation materials, shall be stored and transmitted using encryption standards consistent with Benguet State University data security policies. Society officers shall utilize only University-approved or High Council-vetted digital platforms for records management, communication, and file sharing.

- (ii) Access Control and Authentication. Access to Restricted and Confidential Records shall be governed by role-based permissions managed by the Executive Secretary. All accounts with access to Society records shall require strong password authentication, with mandatory password rotation at least once per semester. Multi-factor authentication shall be enabled for all High Council and House Council officer accounts where supported by the platform.
- (iii) Breach Response Timelines. In addition to the notification requirements under subsection (3), any suspected or confirmed breach of digital security shall be reported to the Executive Secretary and Director of Internal Affairs within twenty-four (24) hours of discovery. A preliminary assessment shall be completed within forty-eight (48) hours, and affected members shall receive written notification within seventy-two (72) hours if personal data is reasonably believed to have been compromised. All breach incidents shall be documented in a confidential Security Incident Log maintained by the Office of Internal Affairs.

(2) *Member Rights*. Members have the right to:

- (a) access their own personal data held by the Society;
- (b) request correction of inaccurate data;
- (c) request deletion of data no longer necessary for Society purposes; and
- (d) withdraw consent for non-essential data processing.

Requests shall be submitted to the Secretary of Internal Affairs and processed within ten (10) business days.

(3) *Breach Response*. In the event of a data breach involving personal information, the High Council shall:

- (a) contain the breach and assess its scope;
- (b) notify affected members within seventy-two (72) hours if sensitive data is compromised; and
- (c) implement corrective measures to prevent recurrence.

(4) *Moral Rights and Attribution*.

- (a) Members who create original materials for Society purposes, including but not limited to debate cases, research briefs, graphic designs, written chronicles, video content, or educational resources, retain moral rights of attribution and integrity under applicable law. When the Society uses, reproduces, or archives member-created materials for official purposes, the creator shall be credited in a manner consistent with academic and professional standards, unless the creator expressly waives attribution in writing.
- (b) Educational License to the Society. By submitting original materials for Society activities, competitions, or publications, members grant the Society a non-exclusive, royalty-free, perpetual license to use, reproduce, distribute, display, and adapt such materials for educational, archival, training, and promotional purposes consistent with the Society's mission. This license shall not permit commercial exploitation or transfer to third parties without the creator's additional written consent.
- (c) Preservation of Creator Rights. Nothing in this subsection shall be construed to transfer ownership of copyright or other intellectual property rights from the creator to the Society. Members retain the right to use, publish, or license their original works independently, provided that such use does not conflict with ongoing Society obligations or confidentiality requirements. The Society shall not claim authorship of member-created works and shall respect reasonable requests to withdraw or restrict use of materials where feasible and consistent with archival integrity.
- (d) University Policy Alignment. All intellectual property practices under this Section shall be interpreted in harmony with Benguet State University policies on student work, academic output, and institutional repositories. Where University policy provides greater protection to student creators, such policy shall prevail.

Section 8. Digital Platform Management.

- (1) *Platform Standards.* The Society's official digital platform shall: (a) provide secure, role-based access controls; (b) maintain an audit log of document views, edits, and downloads; (c) support version control for collaborative documents; and (d) ensure accessibility for members with disabilities.
- (2) *Content Management.* The Office of Public Affairs, in coordination with the Executive Secretary, shall: (a) organize records by category, date, and classification; (b) implement search functionality for Public Records; (c) archive outdated materials while preserving historical integrity; and (d) conduct quarterly reviews to ensure links, permissions, and content remain current.

- (3) *Backup and Recovery.* Critical Society records shall be backed up at least weekly to a secure, off-platform location. A disaster recovery plan shall be maintained by the Executive Secretary and tested annually.

Article IX.
AMENDMENT PROCEDURES, REVIEW CYCLES, AND EFFECTIVITY

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

This Article establishes unified procedures for proposing, deliberating, ratifying, and implementing amendments to these Rules and Procedures. It implements the amendment authority under Article 9 of the Constitution and provides detailed workflows to ensure that operational guidelines evolve responsively while preserving constitutional supremacy. This Article does not alter constitutional amendment thresholds or member rights, but specifies administrative processes to facilitate their exercise. All amendments shall uphold the Society's principles under Article 3, particularly Sections 8 (adaptation to changing needs) and 10 (education as empowerment).

Section 2. Classification of Amendments.

- (1) Amendments to these Rules and Procedures shall be classified as Procedural or Substantive based on their scope and impact.
- (2) Procedural Amendments include changes to:
 - (a) Administrative timelines, submission deadlines, or reporting frequencies;
 - (b) Form templates, ledger formats, or documentation requirements;
 - (c) Internal workflows for point posting, meeting notice, or record access;
 - (d) Annex updates that do not alter binding point values, eligibility criteria, or member rights;
 - (e) Clarifications of language that do not change substantive meaning or effect.
- (3) Substantive Amendments include changes to:
 - (a) Point values, penalties, or bonus structures under Article I;
 - (b) Eligibility criteria, selection processes, or rights under Article III;
 - (c) Voting thresholds, motion types, or participation rights under Article IV;
 - (d) Financial authorization limits, reporting requirements, or prohibited acts under Article V;
 - (e) Definitions of violations, sanction ranges, or due process protections under Article VI;

- (f) Nomination periods, campaign rules, or succession protocols under Article VII;
 - (g) Classification standards, retention periods, or access rights under Article VIII;
 - (h) Any change that affects member rights, obligations, or competitive opportunities as guaranteed under Article 4 of the Constitution.
- (4) *Classification Authority.* The Council of House Chancellors, in consultation with the High Council President, shall make an initial classification of any proposed amendment. This classification is provisional and subject to review by the General Meeting if a member petitions that a Procedural Amendment is in fact Substantive.

Section 3. Proposal and Deliberation Process.

- (1) *Who May Propose.* Amendments may be proposed by:
- (a) The High Council President;
 - (b) The Council of House Chancellors by majority vote;
 - (c) A petition signed by at least twenty-five percent (25%) of active Society members; or
 - (d) A resolution from any House Council, endorsed by its House Chancellor.
- (2) *Submission Requirements.* All proposals shall be submitted in writing to the Executive Secretary and shall include:
- (a) The specific Article, Section, or Annex targeted for amendment;
 - (b) The current text and the proposed revised text;
 - (c) A statement of purpose explaining the rationale and expected impact;
 - (d) For Substantive Amendments, an analysis of alignment with constitutional rights under Article 4;
 - (e) For Procedural Amendments, a certification from the proposing body that the change is administrative in nature.
- (3) *Preliminary Review.* The Executive Secretary, in consultation with the High Council President, shall conduct a preliminary review within five (5) business days to verify completeness and assign a provisional classification (Procedural or Substantive). The proposal shall then be circulated to all House Councils and High Council offices for comment.

- (4) *Deliberation*. All amendments shall be deliberated in a joint session of the High Council and the Council of House Chancellors. The proposing body shall present the amendment, followed by open discussion. Members may submit written comments for inclusion in the record.

Section 4. Approval and Ratification.

- (1) *Procedural Amendments*. Procedural Amendments to these Rules and Procedures shall be approved by:

- (a) A majority vote of the Council of House Chancellors; and
- (b) The concurrence of the High Council President.

This two-track approval process applies exclusively to the Rules and Procedures and shall not be used to amend the Constitution or Society By-Laws, which require general meeting ratification under Article 13, Section 2 of the Constitution.

Upon approval, the amendment shall be posted to the Society's official digital platform and take effect immediately or on a date specified in the approving resolution.

- (2) *Substantive Amendments*. Substantive Amendments shall be approved by:

- (a) A majority vote of the Council of House Chancellors;
- (b) The concurrence of the High Council President; and
- (c) Ratification by majority vote of active members in a Society Assembly Meeting convened for that purpose.

Notice of the General Meeting shall be distributed at least seventy-two (72) hours in advance, with the full text of the proposed amendment included. Ratification shall be conducted by secret ballot. Upon ratification, the amendment shall take effect on the date specified in the ratifying resolution, or at the start of the next semester if no date is specified.

- (3) *Constitutional Consistency Review*. Before any Substantive Amendment is submitted for ratification, the High Tribunal may be requested by any House Chancellor or the President to issue an advisory opinion on whether the amendment is consistent with the Constitution. Such opinion shall be non-binding but shall be included in the materials presented to the General Meeting.

Section 5. Annex Updates and Flexible Revision.

- (1) *Annex Authority.* Annexes to these Rules and Procedures (e.g., Annex A: Debate Performance Criteria) may be updated by majority vote of the High Council with notice to members at least seven (7) days prior to the update taking effect.
- (2) *Limitations.* Annex updates shall not:
 - (a) Alter binding point values, eligibility criteria, or member rights established in the main Articles;
 - (b) Contradict or supersede any provision of the Constitution or the main Articles;
 - (c) Take effect retroactively for activities already completed.
- (3) *Publication.* All annex updates shall be posted to the Society's official digital platform with a change log summarizing revisions. Members may petition the Council of House Chancellors to review an annex update if they believe it exceeds the authority granted under this Section.

Section 6. Review Cycles and Sunset Provisions.

- (1) *Annual Review.* These Rules and Procedures shall be reviewed annually at the end of the Second Semester, following the awarding of the House Cup. The review shall be led by the Council of House Chancellors in coordination with the High Council and shall assess:
 - (a) The effectiveness and fairness of operational frameworks;
 - (b) Alignment with constitutional principles and Society values;
 - (c) Responsiveness to member feedback and institutional changes;
 - (d) Opportunities for simplification, consolidation, or improvement.
- (2) *Mid-Year Check-In.* An informal check-in shall be conducted at the end of the First Semester to identify urgent issues requiring procedural adjustment. Only Procedural Amendments may be adopted at this time.
- (3) *Sunset Review for Pilot Provisions.* Any provision adopted as a pilot or temporary measure shall include a sunset clause specifying its expiration date. Extension or permanent adoption shall require the full amendment process under Section 4.
- (4) *Sunset Review Requirements for Pilot Provisions.*
 - (a) *Explicit Expiration Dates.* Any provision adopted as a pilot, experimental, or temporary measure shall include in its adopting resolution a specific expiration date, which shall not exceed two(2) academic years from the date of effectivity.

The expiration date shall be prominently stated in the published text of the provision and in all related communications to members.

- (b) Permanent Adoption Process. Conversion of a pilot provision into a permanent Rule or Procedure shall require classification and ratification under the full amendment process specified in Section 4 of this Article. If the pilot provision affects member rights, obligations, or competitive opportunities, it shall be classified as a Substantive Amendment and shall require:

- (i) majority vote of the Council of House Chancellors;
- (ii) concurrence of the High Council President; and
- (iii) ratification by majority vote of active members in a Society Assembly Meeting convened for that purpose.

If the pilot provision is purely administrative, it may be classified as a Procedural Amendment subject to approval under Section 4(1).

- (c) Automatic Lapse Procedures. Upon the expiration date specified under subsection (a), any pilot provision not formally extended or permanently adopted through the process in subsection (b) shall automatically lapse and cease to have force or effect. The Executive Secretary shall issue a Notice of Lapse at least fourteen(14) calendar days prior to the expiration date, reminding relevant officers and members of the impending lapse and the procedures for extension or permanent adoption.

- (d) Transition Guidance. Upon lapse of a pilot provision under subsection (c), all activities, decisions, or rights accrued under the provision prior to expiration shall remain valid and enforceable. Pending matters initiated under the pilot provision shall be resolved under the general Rules and Procedures in effect at the time of lapse, unless the adopting resolution specified alternative transition procedures. The High Council may issue transitional guidance to ensure continuity of operations, provided such guidance does not extend the substantive effect of the lapsed provision beyond its expiration date.

- (e) Extension Protocol. A pilot provision may be extended for a single additional period not exceeding one(1) academic year by:

- (i) majority vote of the Council of House Chancellors;
- (ii) concurrence of the High Council President; and

- (iii) publication of a Notice of Extension at least seven(7) calendar days prior to the original expiration date.

No pilot provision shall be extended more than once; subsequent continuation shall require permanent adoption under subsection (b).

Section 7. Effectivity, Transitory Provisions, and Constitutional Supremacy.

- (1) *Effectivity*. These Rules and Procedures, and any amendments thereto, shall take effect upon:

- (a) *For Procedural Amendments*: Approval by the Council of House Chancellors and concurrence of the High Council President;

- (b) *For Substantive Amendments*: Ratification by majority vote in a Society Assembly Meeting as mandated by Article 9, Section 2 of the Constitution.

- (2) *Transitory Provisions*. Upon adoption of these Rules and Procedures or any major amendment:

- (a) A transition period of up to thirty (30) days may be observed to allow for orientation, system setup, and training;

- (b) During transition, relaxed deadlines or provisional procedures may be applied as specified in the adopting resolution;

- (c) Rights or obligations accrued under prior rules shall be honored unless expressly modified by the amendment.

- (3) *Constitutional Supremacy*. In the event of any conflict between these Rules and Procedures and the Constitution of the BSU Debate Society, the Constitution shall prevail. Any provision of these Rules found to be inconsistent with the Constitution shall be deemed null and void to the extent of the inconsistency, without affecting the validity of the remaining provisions.

Section 8. Publication, Accessibility, and Member Education.

- (1) *Publication*. The full text of these Rules and Procedures, as amended, shall be posted to the Society's official digital platform within five (5) business days of effectivity. A summary of changes shall be presented at the next Society Assembly Meeting.

- (2) *Accessibility*. All active members shall have view access to the current and archived versions of these Rules and Procedures. The Executive Secretary shall maintain a version history with effective dates and amendment summaries.

- (3) *Member Education.* The Office of Internal Affairs, in coordination with House Councils, shall conduct an orientation session on these Rules and Procedures for new members within the first month of each academic year. Summary guides shall include a Constitutional Cross-Reference Appendix mapping key Rules provisions (e.g., point system, disciplinary process, election protocols) to their enabling constitutional authorities, to prevent future interpretive conflicts.

Section 9. Final Provisions.

- (1) *Severability.* If any provision of these Rules and Procedures is held invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect.
- (2) *Repealer.* All prior rules, procedures, or guidelines inconsistent with these Rules and Procedures are hereby repealed upon effectivity, except to the extent they are expressly incorporated herein.
- (3) *Interpretation.* These Rules and Procedures shall be interpreted in a manner that promotes the Society's mission, protects member rights, and facilitates constructive competition. In case of ambiguity, the interpretation that best aligns with the Constitution and the principles under Article 3 shall prevail.
- (4) *Custodianship.* The Executive Secretary shall serve as the formal custodian of these Rules and Procedures, responsible for maintaining the official text, archiving amendments, and certifying copies for official use.

ANNEX A: DEBATE PERFORMANCE CRITERIA

Individual Debate Point System under Article III, Section 2(2) of the Rules and Procedures

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

This Annex establishes the specific criteria and point values for earning Individual Debate Points under Article III (The Debate League) of the Rules and Procedures. These points determine eligibility for Debate League membership and are tracked separately from House Points (Article I) and Individual Recognition Awards (Article II).

Section 2. Eligible Activities.

Individual Debate Points may be earned through participation in the following activities, provided they are approved by the High Council for point eligibility:

(1) Society-Wide Debates

- (a) Inter-House Debate Cup matches (Article I, Section 10(1)).
- (b) Society-organized open tournaments.
- (c) Practice debates designated as point-eligible by the High Council.

(2) House-Wide Debates.

- (a) House-organized debate sessions approved in advance by the High Council.
- (b) House selection trials for external competitions.
- (c) Internal House tournaments with documented judging results.

(3) External Competitions.

- (a) Tournaments where members represent Benguet State University or the Debate Society.
- (b) Competitions recognized by the High Council as legitimate academic, student, or professional debating events.

Section 3. Point Values by Activity Type

A. Society-Wide and Approved House-Wide Debates

Performance Metric	Points Awarded	Notes
Match Win	+15 points	Awarded to each debater on the winning team

Match Draw	+7 points	Awarded to each debater in a tied decision
Match Participation	+3 points	Awarded to each debater who completes a scheduled match
Best Speaker (per debate)	+10 points	Awarded to individual recognized by the judges
Top 3 Speakers (per tournament)	+5 points each	For 2nd and 3rd place speaker awards

B. External Competitions (Representing BSU/Debate Society)

Achievement Level	Points Awarded	Documentation Required
International Championship/1st Place	+50 points	Official certificate, published results
International Finalist/Semi-Finalist	+40 points	Official certificate, published results
International Participation	+15 points	Registration confirmation, attendance proof
National Championship/1st Place	+45 points	Official certificate, published results
National Participation	+12 points	Registration confirmation, attendance proof
Regional Championship/1st Place	+35 points	Official certificate, published results
Regional Finalist/Semi-Finalist	+25 points	Official certificate, published results
Regional Participation	+10 points	Registration confirmation, attendance proof
Local/Inter-School Championship	+25 points	Official certificate, published results

Local/Inter-School Finalist/Semi-Finalist	+18 points	Official certificate, published results
Local/Inter-School Participation	+8 points	Registration confirmation, attendance proof

C. Speaker and Individual Performance Awards (External)

Award Type	Points Awarded	Documentation Required
Best Speaker (any external tournament)	+20 points	Official certificate, tournament results page, or letter from tournament director confirming award
Top 3 Speaker (2nd/3rd place)	+12 points each	Published results listing speaker rankings, or official award certificate
Best Rebuttal/Reply Speaker	+10 points	Award certificate, official communication from organizing body, or official results indicating category win
Best Case Construction Award	+10 points	Certificate, published results, or official communication from organizing body

Section 4. Point Accumulation Rules

(1) *Cumulative Tracking.*

- (a) Individual Debate Points accumulate throughout the academic year.
- (b) Points reset to zero (0) at the start of each new academic year (Article III, Section 2(3)).

(2) *Non-Stacking Provision.* No single performance shall earn points under multiple categories for the same event.

(3) *Team vs. Individual Attribution.*

- (a) Team-based awards award points to each member of the team who participated in the competition.
- (b) Individual awards award points only to the recognized recipient.

(4) *Role-Based Eligibility*

- (a) Points are awarded only to members who actively debated or presented in the competition.
- (b) Alternate debaters who did not speak in any round shall receive 50% of participation points only, unless they contributed to case preparation documented by the team captain,

Section 5. Documentation and Verification

(1) *Submission Requirements.* Members claiming Individual Debate Points must submit a Point Claim Form to the Secretary of Internal Affairs within fourteen (14) calendar days of the activity's completion, including:

- (a) Name, House, and membership status of the claimant.
- (b) Date, name, and organizing body of the activity.
- (c) Category of points claimed with reference to this Annex.
- (d) Specific point amount claimed.
- (e) Supporting documentation:
 - (i) For Society/House debates: signed attendance sheet, judge's decision sheet, or certification from the event organizer.
 - (ii) For external competitions: Official certificate, published results, registration confirmation, or letter from tournament director.
 - (iii) For speaker awards: Copy of award certificate or official results listing.

(2) *Verification Process.*

- (a) The Secretary of Internal Affairs shall verify claims within five (5) business days.
- (b) Claims may be cross-referenced with House Council reports, tournament records, or external verification.

- (c) Insufficient documentation shall result in a request for amendment within three (3) days; failure to comply shall result in claim denial.

(3) *Posting and Provisional Status.*

- (a) Verified points shall be posted to the Individual Debate Point Ledger within three (3) business days.
- (b) Postings shall be marked Provisional Subject to Petition for seven (7) calendar days.
- (c) Any member may petition a posting within the petition period on grounds of inaccurate documentation, misclassification, or procedural error.

(4) *Finalization.*

- (a) If no petition is filed within the seven day period, points become final and executory.
- (b) Finalized points shall be used for Debate League selection under Article III, Section 3.

Section 6. Dispute Resolution.

(1) *Grounds for Petition.* A member may petition a point posting on the following grounds:

- (a) The activity does not qualify under Section 2 of this Annex;
- (b) Documentation is insufficient, inaccurate, or fabricated;
- (c) Point value claimed does not match the criteria in Section 3; or
- (d) The member was not an active participant in the claimed capacity.

(2) *Adjudication.*

- (a) Petitions shall be reviewed by the High Tribunal convened for point disputes (Article I, Section 2(7)).
- (b) The President shall serve as Presiding Judge; the three uninvolved House Chancellors shall deliberate and vote.
- (c) A decision shall be rendered within fourteen (14) calendar days of petition filing.
- (d) The Tribunal's decision on point transactions is final and executory, with no further appeal unless a constitutional violation is alleged.

(3) *Penalty for False Claims.* If a Point Claim Form is found to contain knowingly false or materially inaccurate information:

- (a) The claim points shall be forfeited;
- (b) A penalty deduction equal to the claimed amount shall be applied to the member's Individual Debate Point tally; and
- (c) The matter may be referred to the Office of Internal Affairs for disciplinary review under Article VI.

Section 7. Special Provisions.

(1) *Hybrid or Online Competitions.*

- (a) Points for online or hybrid-format debates shall follow the same values as in-person events, provided the competition maintains formal judging, documented results, and academic integrity standards approved by the High Council.

(2) *Multi-Day or Multi-Round Tournaments.* For tournaments with preliminary and elimination rounds:

- (a) Participation points are awarded once per tournament, not per round;
- (b) Placement points are awarded based on final tournament standing; and
- (c) Best Speaker awards are awarded per the tournament's official designation.

(3) *Co-Participation with Other Organizations.* When the Society co-hosts an event with another organization, points shall be awarded only if:

- (a) The event is pre-approved by the High Council for point eligibility;
- (b) Judging criteria and documentation standards meet Society requirements; and
- (c) Results are jointly certified and submitted per Section 5.

(4) *Retroactive Claims.* Points may not be claimed for activities completed prior to the ratification of this Annex, except as provided in Article III, Section 8 (Transitory Provision).

ANNEX B: OPERATIONAL COMPLIANCE TEMPLATES

Section 1. Purpose and Scope.

This annex establishes standardized administrative templates to facilitate compliance with operational requirements under the Constitution and Rules and Procedures of the BSU Debate Society. Use of these templates is mandatory where expressly required by governing provisions. Templates shall be maintained in digital format by the Office of the Executive Secretary, with updates subject to the amendment procedures under Article IX. All submissions shall be processed in accordance with the data privacy principles under Article VIII, Section 7 of these Rules.

Section 2. Annual Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form.

(For High Council and House Council Officers)

Legal Basis: Constitution Article 7, Section 3(1)(h)(i); Rules Article VIII, Section 7(1)(f)

A. Required Fields:

(1) Officer Information:

- (a) Full Name and House Affiliation
- (b) Office/Position Held (High Council or House Council)
- (c) Term of Service (Semester/Academic Year)
- (d) Date of Submission

(2) Disclosure Categories (Check all that apply and provide details):

- (a) Financial Interest: Do you, or an immediate family member, hold a financial interest in any vendor, supplier, or entity with which the Society or your House has conducted or may conduct business? ☐ Yes ☐ No
If Yes, describe nature, entity name, and estimated value: _____
- (b) Competitive Advantage: Are you currently involved in any external debate organization, tournament series, or competitive initiative that may create a perceived or actual advantage for your House in Society point calculations? ☐ Yes ☐ No
If Yes, describe nature and potential impact: _____
- (c) Personal Relationship: Do you have a close personal, familial, or professional relationship with any member, officer, or external party that may reasonably be perceived to impair your impartiality in deliberations,

disciplinary proceedings, or resource allocations? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If Yes, describe relationship and relevant context: _____

- (d) Prior Consultation: Have you participated in unofficial consultations negotiations regarding any matter pending before your Council that may compromise objective judgment? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If Yes, describe matter and nature of involvement: _____

(3) Certification Statement:

“I certify that the information provided herein is true and complete to the best of my knowledge. I acknowledge my duty to recuse myself from any matter in which I have disclosed a conflict, and to update this disclosure should circumstances change during my term.”

Signature: _____ Date: _____

B. Submissions Instructions:

- (1) This Form shall be submitted annually within fourteen (14) calendar days of assumption of office, and updated within seven (7) days of any material change in disclosed circumstances.
- (2) High Council officers shall submit to the Executive Secretary and the Director of Internal Affairs. House Council officers shall submit to their House Secretariat Director and furnish a copy to the Society Office of Internal Affairs.
- (3) Submissions shall be made via the Society’ secure digital platform in a sealed envelope marked “CONFIDENTIAL - CONFLICT DISCLOSURE.”

C. Privacy Notice:

Disclosures shall be treated as Restricted Records under Article VIII, Section 2(2) of these Rules. Access shall be limited to the Executive Secretary, Director of Internal Affairs, and adjudicating bodies where recusal or conflict determination is required. Unauthorized disclosure of submitted information shall constitute a Major Violation under Article VI, Section 2(2)(b).

Section 3. AI-Assisted Case & Research Disclosure Template.

(For Competition Submissions)

Legal Basis: Article 3, Section 11; Rules Article I, Section 3(1); Annex A, Section 5

A. Required Fields:

(1) Submission Metadata:

- (a) Case/Research Title and Topic
- (b) Competition/Tournament Name and Date
- (c) Submitting Member(s) Name(s) and House Affiliation
- (d) Role in Submission (Author, Researcher, Editor, etc.)

(2) AI Tool Disclosure:

- (a) List all artificial intelligence, machine learning, or automated research tools utilized in preparation: _____
- (b) For each tool, specify purpose of use (e.g., literature review, argument generation, citation formatting, language editing): _____
- (c) Indicate whether tool output was used verbatim, adapted, or used solely for ideation: _____

(3) Human Verification Statement:

“I affirm that all substantive arguments, factual assertions, and analytical conclusions contained in this submission have been reviewed, verified, and approved by human author(s). AI-assisted content has been critically evaluated for accuracy, relevance, and ethical compliance. I accept full responsibility for the intellectual integrity of this work.”

Signature(s): _____ Date: _____

(4) Attribution Log (Optional but Recommended):

Source/Tool	Content Type	Extent of Use	Verification Method

B. Submission Instructions:

- (1) This Template shall accompany all case briefs, research packages, or position papers submitted for Society-sanctioned competitions, inter-House tournaments, or external representation under Article III.
- (2) Submissions shall be filed with the tournament director, House Chancellor, or Office of Internal Affairs as required by event protocols.

- (3) Failure to submit a completed disclosure may result in provisional disqualification pending review by the High Tribunal under Article I, Section 5(5).

C. Privacy Notice:

Disclosures shall be treated as Public Records under Article VIII, Section 2(1) to the extent they accompany publicly submitted materials. Proprietary methodology details may be redacted upon request. Adjudicators and tournament officials shall have access for integrity verification purposes only.

Section 4. Emergency Continuity Activation Checklist.

(For Force Majeure Scenarios)

Legal Basis: Constitution Article 8, Section 2(5)(b)-(c); Rules Article IV, Section 9(1)(e)

A. Required Fields:

(1) Activation Authority:

(a) Declaring Officer (President/Vice President/House Chancellor):

(b) Date and Time of Declaration: _____

(c) Basis for Declaration (check one):

☐ Institutional closure order

☐ Public health emergency directive

☐ Natural disaster or environmental hazard

☐ Security threat or civil unrest

☐ Other extraordinary circumstance: _____

(2) Quorum Verification Protocol:

(a) Virtual Platform Selected: _____

(b) Authentication Method (e.g., email, two-factor verification): _____

(c) Roll Call Completed: ☐ Yes ☐ no

(d) Verified Participants: _____ of _____ entitled members (minimum 50% + 1 required)

(3) Action Documentation Requirements:

- (a) Meeting minutes recorded via platform logging or designated scribe: ☐ Yes ☐ No
- (b) Vote tallies captured with timestamp and participant verification: ☐ Yes ☐ No
- (c) Emergency justification appended to official record: ☐ Yes ☐ No

(4) Ratification Timeline:

- (a) Anticipated date of restored physical convening capacity: _____
- (b) Deadline for physical quorum ratification (14 calendar days from restoration): _____
- (c) Designated officer responsible for tracking ratification: _____

B. Submission Instructions:

- (1) This Checklist shall be completed contemporaneously with any meeting convened under Emergency Quorum procedures.
- (2) The completed Checklist shall be submitted to the Executive Secretary within twenty-four (24) hours of adjournment for archival in the Society Disciplinary Ledger under Article VIII, Section 3.
- (3) Failure to complete required documentation may render actions taken under Emergency Quorum advisory only, subject to re-deliberation under Article IV, Section 9(1)(e).

C. Privacy Notice:

Checklists containing sensitive operational details shall be classified as Restricted Records under Article VIII, Section 2(2). Summary reports of emergency actions shall be published to the Society Assembly Meeting per Article IV, Section 9(1)(e), with redaction of security-sensitive information.

Section 5. Mentorship Pairing & Progress Ledger.

(For Tracking Executive Intern Development)

Legal Basis: Constitution Article 5, Section 2(b); Rules Article VI, Section 4

A. Required Fields:

(1) Pairing Information:

(a) Executive Intern Name, House, and Admission Date: _____

(b) Assigned Full Member Mentor Name, House, and Office Assignment:

(c) Supervising High Council Secretary: _____

(d) Internship Period (Start Date - End Date): _____

(2) Competency Module Tracking:

Module Title	Completion Date	Verified By	Status
Parliamentary Procedure Fundamentals			☐ Complete
Debate Theory & Case Construction			☐ Complete
Ethical Conduct and Society Values			☐ Complete
Organizational Management Protocols			☐ Complete
Operational Systems Training			☐ Complete

(3) Milestone Evaluation:

(a) Satisfactory completion of assigned operational tasks: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Comments: _____

(b) Mentor evaluation of professionalism, initiative, and growth: _____

Rating:

☐ Exceeds Expectations

☐ Meets Expectations

☐ Needs Improvement

(c) Reflective portfolio submitted and reviewed: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Date of Review: _____

(4) Progression Determination:

“Based on the above evaluations, the Executive Intern is:

☐ Recommended for elevation to Full Membership status

☐ Recommended for extension of internship with specified remediation:

☐ Not recommended for progression; reasons: _____”

Mentor Signature: _____ Date: _____

Supervising Secretary Signature: _____ Date: _____

B. Submission Instructions:

- (1) This Ledger shall be initiated upon assignment of an Executive Intern and updated upon completion of each competency module and milestone.
- (2) Final evaluation shall be submitted to the Office of Internal Affairs within seven(7) calendar days of internship completion for verification of Full Membership eligibility under Article 5, Section 2(c).
- (3) Copies shall be retained by the mentor, intern, and supervising Secretary for reference during the progression review process.

C. Privacy Notice:

Ledger entries constitute member development records under Article VIII, Section 2(2)(b) and shall be accessible only to the intern, mentor, supervising officers, and the Office of Internal Affairs. Aggregate, anonymized data may be used for program evaluation purposes with High Council approval.

Section 6. Whistleblower Confidential Intake Form.

(For Secure Misconduct Reporting)

Legal Basis: Constitution Article 3, Section 14; Rules Article VI, Section 4(6)

A. Required Fields:

(1) Reporting Channel Selection:

(a) Submission Method (check one):

☐ Secure digital portal (Society OIA Platform)

☐ Encrypted email to OIA Director

☐ Sealed physical delivery to Chief Adviser

☐ In-person confidential interview (by appointment)

(2) Discloser Preferences:

(a) Do you wish to remain anonymous? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If No, provide contact information for follow-up: _____

(b) Preferred method for status updates (if anonymous, updates will be posted to secure portal with case reference): _____

(3) Disclosure Content:

(a) Nature of Alleged Misconduct (check all that apply):

☐ Constitutional violation

☐ Financial irregularity or misappropriation

☐ Ethical breach or code of conduct violation

☐ Retaliation or intimidation

☐ Threat to member safety or institutional integrity

☐ Other: _____

(b) Parties Involved (names, positions, Houses – provide only what is known):

(c) Factual Summary (include dates, locations, witnesses, and supporting evidence references): _____

(d) Supporting Documentation (attach or reference; do not submit original documents): _____

(4) Good Faith Certification:

“I declare that this disclosure is made in good faith based on information reasonably believed to be true. I understand that knowingly false or malicious reports may constitute a Major Violation under Article VI, Section 2(2)(b), and that anonymity protections do not extend to disclosures made with intent to harm or deceive.”

Anonymous Identifier (if applicable): _____

Date of Submission: _____

B. Submission Instructions:

- (1) This Form shall be submitted directly to the Society Office of Internal Affairs or the Chief Adviser through the secure channels specified above. Do not submit to House Councils or other officers unless they are the subject of the disclosure.
- (2) Upon receipt, the OIA Director or Chief Adviser shall acknowledge submission within forty-eight (48) hours via the discloser's preferred method, assigning a confidential case reference number.
- (3) Investigations shall commence within seven (7) business days unless extraordinary circumstances warrant delay, with periodic status updates provided per the discloser's preferences.

C. Privacy Notice:

All submissions shall be treated as Confidential Records under Article VIII, Section 2(3) of these Rules. Identity of anonymous disclosers shall be protected through technical and procedural safeguards, including redaction of identifying information and limitation of access to authorized adjudicating personnel. Retaliation against any discloser acting in good faith is strictly prohibited and shall constitute a Major Violation subject to sanctions under Article VI, Section 4(6)(d)-(e).